

Low breadth is a feature not a bug

Low breadth is a feature not a bug

While the S&P and Nasdaq remain resilient to the continued surge in bond yields, they are doing so with historically poor breadth. The AI trade continues to overcome macro headwinds, with US tech showing an asymmetric reaction function to the upside (e.g., ~3x bigger rallies on lower yields than selloffs on higher yields). Divergences between US tech and more rates-sensitive pockets of the market are only adding fuel to elevated dispersion levels. As tech optimism and FOMO overcome macro/policy uncertainty and crowd out other narratives, investors unwilling to lean into narrow AI/tech leadership increasingly risk underperforming in our view. And as we pointed out in our [2026 Outlook](#), low breadth is a classic feature of bubbles building and typically doesn't stop until they pop. To hedge right tail risks, we continue to like QQQ call spreads as an attractive, risk-limited upside expression (which can be cheapened further by selling OTM puts), while we see NDX calls contingent on higher rates as offering a cheap, risk-limited way to play US tech and bond yields continuing to trend higher together.

Autocallification is shaping vol, supports vol calendars

The structural growth of derivatives income is increasingly leaving its mark on volatility markets. In our recent report, [When Income became an Outcome](#), we highlighted how broader demand for cash flow, diversification beyond traditional fixed income, higher equity vol, product innovation and the mainstreaming of options are fuelling the growth of derivatives-based income strategies. With structured-product issuance remaining strong (particularly in North America) and equities rallying, that growth is translating into an increasingly visible "autocallification" effect. SPX, NDX, RTY and SX5E are now all trading close to peak Vanna from live structured products, suggesting dealer vol-dampening flows are near their strongest. The impact is most significant in semis and US tech among single stocks. With longer-dated vol increasingly influenced by this structural dealer supply but near-term markets still vulnerable to episodic positioning-driven dislocations, we think this strengthens the case for vol calendars that use longer-dated short vol to help fund short-dated long gamma.

Also in the GEVI

Global x-asset stress returns to highest levels since April with rates vol leading the way
BRI: As healthcare BRIs retreat, semis rebound

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Refer to important disclosures on page 23 to 26. Analyst Certification on page 23. 13024577

06 October 2026

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Exhibit 1: 3M volatility (1-week chg)

Level & changes (in parentheses) in vol pts

	Implied	Realized
S&P500	14.1 (0.3)	11.0 (-0.2)
ESTX50	16.7 (1.3)	12.0 (0.0)
FTSE	13.5 (1.3)	9.2 (0.1)
DAX	16.9 (1.1)	11.9 (-0.7)
NKY	24.8 (0.4)	27.6 (-1.7)
HSCEI	19.4 (-0.2)	18.3 (0.2)
KOSPI	39.0 (-1.8)	73.6 (-1.8)
EEM US	23.5 (0.2)	23.6 (-1.3)
XIN9I	16.9 (-0.5)	18.6 (-0.8)

Source: BofA Global Research

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See list of acronyms at the end of the report

BofA GFSI™ X-Asset Risk Landscape

Rates vol stress climbs again as the GFSI turns positive

The GFSI rose from -0.05 on 25-Sep-26 to +0.06 on 2-Oct-26. This brings the index to its 53rd percentile since 2000. The GFSI reached +0.10 on Thursday, its highest level since 13-Apr-26. Despite ending Q3 in positive territory, the index averaged -0.12 from July to September, below its Q2 and Q1 averages of -0.10 and +0.01, respectively.

Volume flow, which measures bullish and bearish US stock volume, recorded the largest increase in stress among GFSI subcomponents last week as it saw a 92nd percentile increase in stress versus its own history (Exhibit 3 & Exhibit 6). As the only equity component among the top five stress-gainers of the week, volume flow was the main driver of equities posting the largest increase in stress at the asset class level (Exhibit 4).

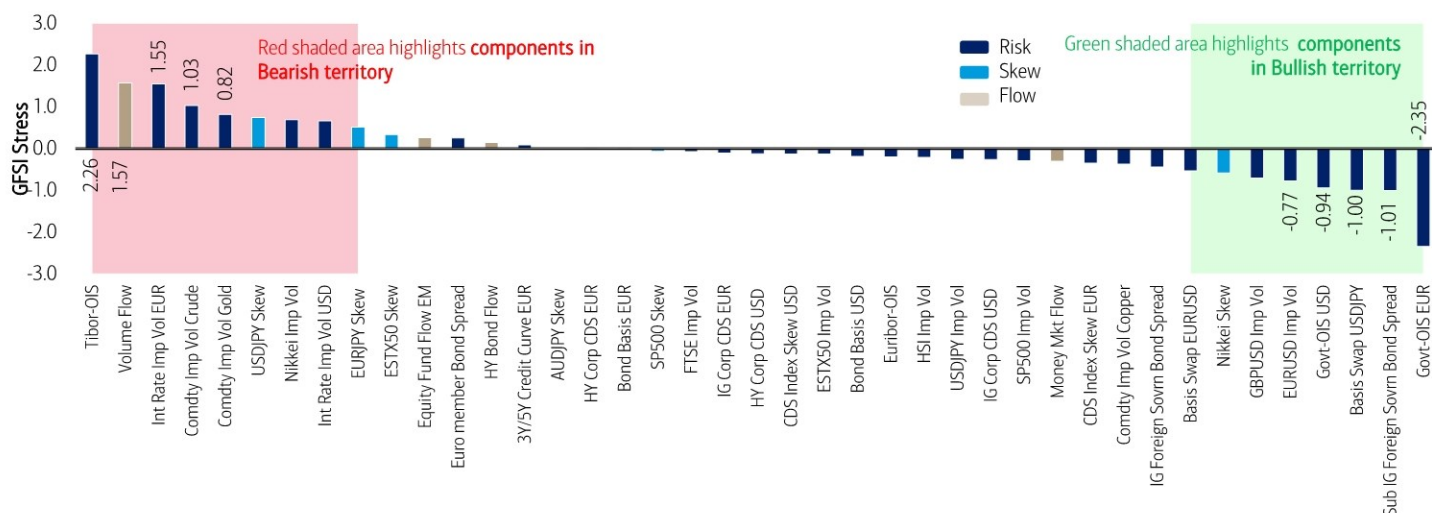
In contrast, rates stress declined last week due to Govt-OIS EUR, despite global yields continuing to climb. However, rates vol once again recorded the largest increase in stress among all cross-asset vols and spreads (Exhibit 4 & Exhibit 7). EUR and USD interest rate implied vols were again among the week's five largest stress gainers, and interest rate implied vol USD entered bearish territory with stress more than half a standard deviation above its historical median (Exhibit 2 & Exhibit 3). The last time the GFSI was above +0.10 in April, commodity vol was the top contributor to stress, but rates vol is now in the driver's seat.

Among the remaining asset classes, credit and FX stress also increased while commodity stress declined (Exhibit 4). Euro member bond spread stress recorded the second largest increase with a 99.5th percentile gain relative to its own history (Exhibit 3 & Exhibit 6).

- **The US led regional stress higher**, although Japan remains the only region with stress above its historical median (Exhibit 5).

Exhibit 2: Latest* stress across GFSI sub-components

Tibor-OIS is the most stressed while Govt-OIS EUR is the least stressed



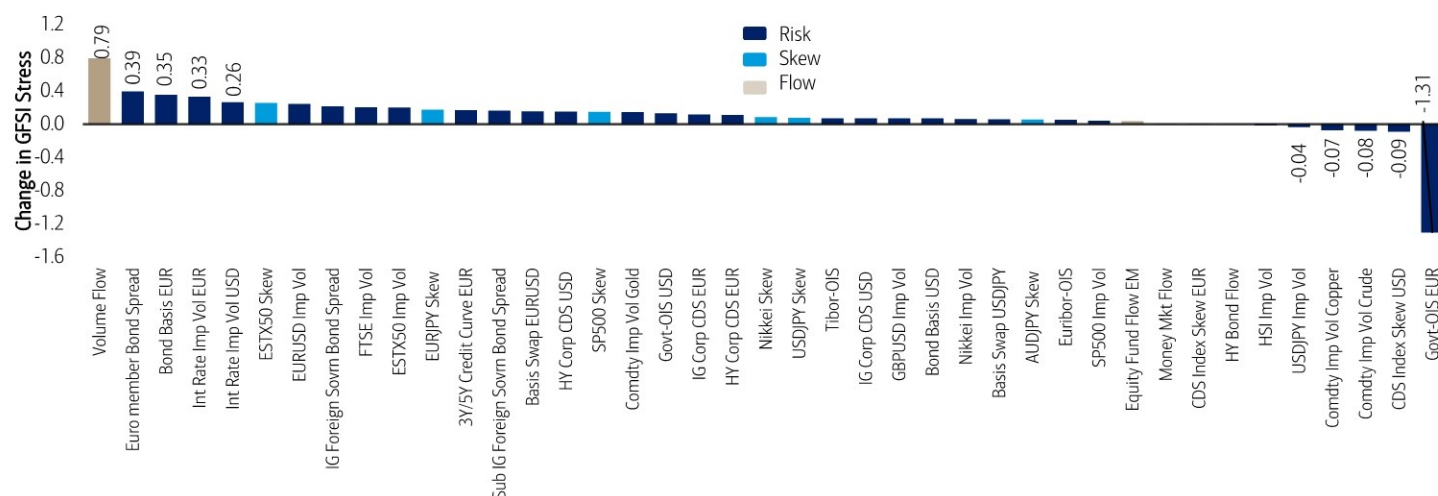
Source: BofA Global Research. *Latest as of 2-Oct-26. Disclaimer: The indicator identified above as BofA GFSI is intended to be an indicative metric only and may not be used for reference purposes or as a measure of performance for any financial instrument or contract, or otherwise relied upon by third parties for any other purpose, without the prior written consent of BofA Global Research. This indicator was not created to act as a benchmark.

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Exhibit 3: Change in stress across GFSI sub-components**

Volume flow was the largest stress riser over the last week while Govt-OIS EUR stress fell the most



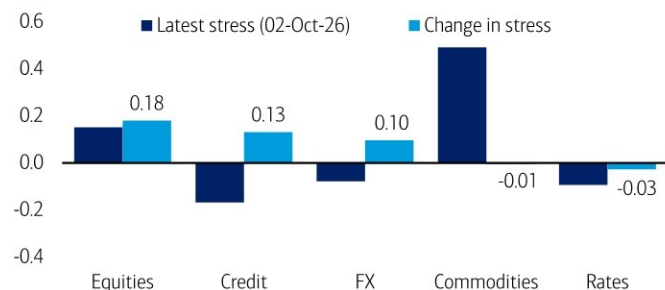
Source: BofA Global Research. **Latest as of 2-Oct-26. Change from 25-Sep-26 to 2-Oct-26.

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The GFSI Risk Allocator (using Bull, Bear & Neutral weights of 2, 0, 1) suggested a 2.4% underweight position as of 2-Oct-26 (vs a 4.9% overweight position as of 25-Sep-26). The percentages of Bullish, Bearish, and Neutral GFSI components (as used in the Risk Allocator) as of 2-Oct-26 were 19.5%, 22.0%, and 58.5%, respectively.

Exhibit 4: Equity stress increased the most last week

On the other hand, rates stress decreased the most

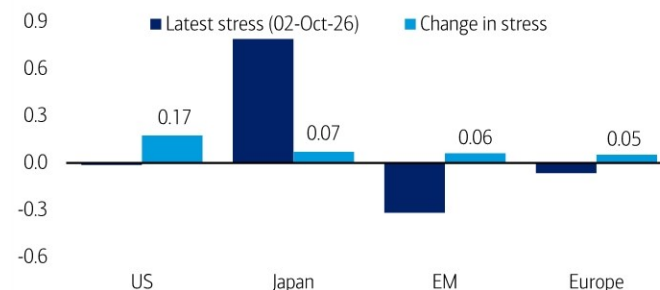


Source: BofA Global Research. Change from 25-Sep-26 to 2-Oct-26.

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Exhibit 5: The US led regional stress higher last week

In contrast, Europe recorded the smallest increase

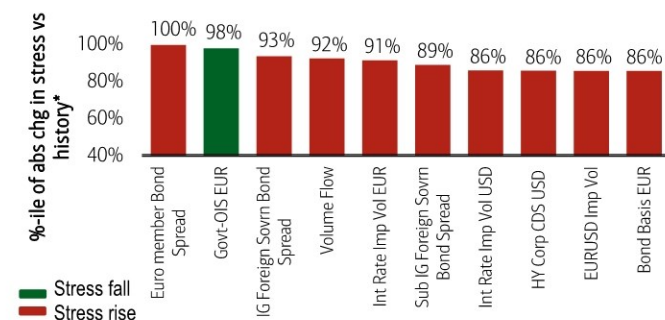


Source: BofA Global Research. Change from 25-Sep-26 to 2-Oct-26.

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Exhibit 6: Top 10 biggest stress movers (vs history)

Euro member bond spread saw a historically large stress increase

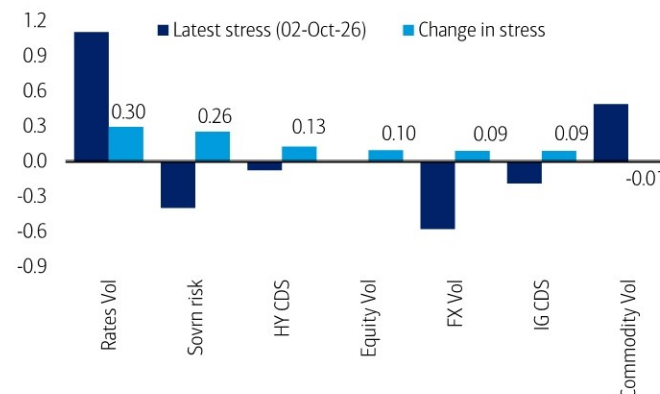


Source: BofA Global Research. * %-ile of 5-day moves in stress vs all historical 5-day moves (earliest 3-Jan-00). Bar colors represent rise (red) or fall (green) in stress. 5-day change (25-Sep-26 to 2-Oct-26).

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Exhibit 7: Biggest stress movers in cross-asset vols and spreads

Rates vol experienced the largest increase in stress last week



Source: BofA Global Research. Change from 25-Sep-26 to 2-Oct-26.

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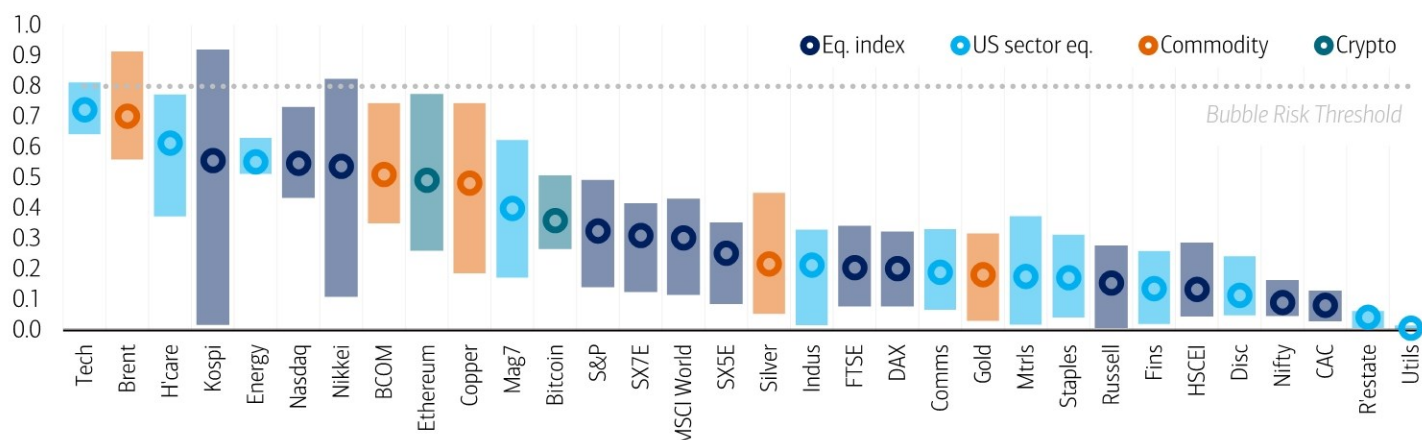
BofA Bubble Risk Indicator Landscape

As healthcare BRIs retreat, semis rebound

The **BofA Bubble Risk Indicator (BRI)** is a price-based measure designed to detect bubble-like asset dynamics. Inspired by the way the first four moments describe a statistical distribution, the BRI distills an asset's returns, volatility, momentum, and fragility into a single bubble-risk reading on a 0 to 1 scale; 1 represents extreme bubble-like price action while 0 represents none. Historic asset bubbles have exhibited high BRI levels as they formed and peaked (see our [2026 Year Ahead](#) for more details).

Exhibit 8: While BRI levels on US healthcare stocks retreat further, they remain resilient on US tech stocks, which currently rank with the highest BRI reading

BofA Bubble Risk indicator (as of 02-Oct-26) across global equity indices, US equity sectors, commodities and crypto (bars: range of short- to long-term sub-indicators)

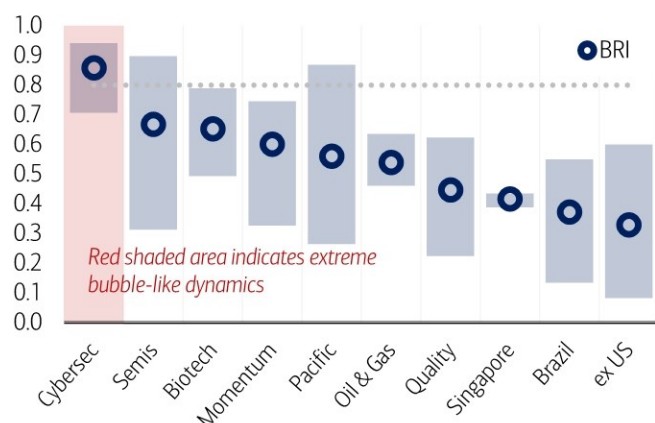


Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 02-Oct-26. Underlying tickers: SPX, NDX, RTY, SX5E, SX7E, CAC, DAX, UKX, NKY, HSCEI, KOSPI2, NIFTY, MXWD, IXB, IXCP, IXE, IXM, IXI, IXT, IXR, IXRE, IXU, IXV, IXZ, BM7P, BCOM, CO1, XAU, XAG, HG1, XBTUSD, XETUSD. Disclaimer: The indicator identified as the BofA Bubble Risk Indicator is intended to be an indicative metric only and may not be used for reference purposes or as a measure of performance for any financial instrument or contract, or otherwise relied upon by third parties for any other purpose, without the prior written consent of BofA Global Research. This indicator was not created to act as a benchmark.

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Exhibit 9: Cybersecurity stocks are showing relatively high bubble-like dynamics among popular equity themes

Highest BRI readings across popular equity themes (as of 02-Oct-26)

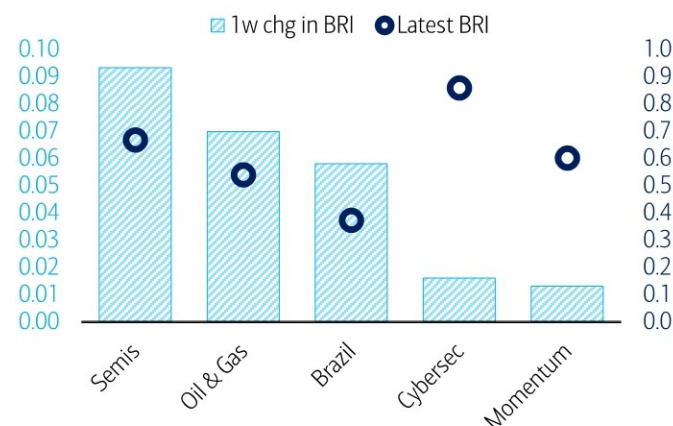


Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 02-Oct-26. Underlying tickers: NQCYBRN, DZETR, ICEBIOT, SP500MUT, ACDAPR, SP5IOPTR, JQUATR, M1CXBISC, M1BR2550, NDUACWZ. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Exhibit 10: Semis stocks have seen the biggest jump in their Bubble Risk Indicator over the past week among popular equity themes

Largest 1w changes in BRI across popular equity themes (as of 02-Oct-26)



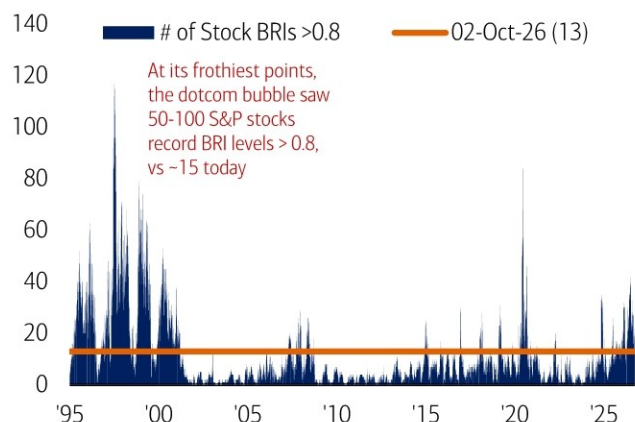
Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 02-Oct-26. Underlying tickers: DZETR, SP5IOPTR, M1BR2550, NQCYBRN, SP500MUT. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Exhibit 11: Compared with the late 90s dotcom bubble, froth in SPX stocks remains localized, both in terms of number of stocks ...

of SPX stocks with BRIs above 0.8

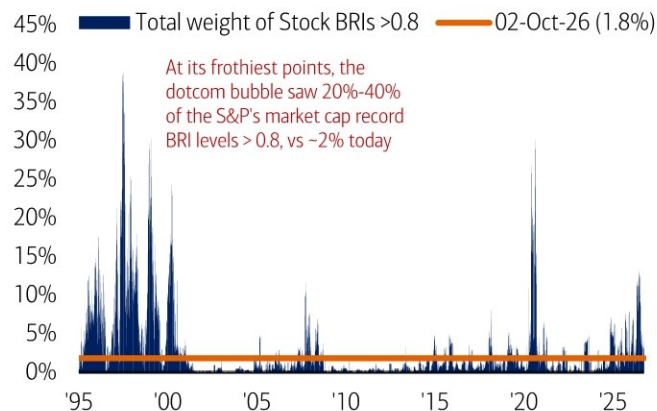


Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-95 to 02-Oct-26. Stocks' BRI computed using data since SPX inclusion. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Exhibit 12: ... and when measured by total index weight

Total weight of SPX stocks with BRIs above 0.8

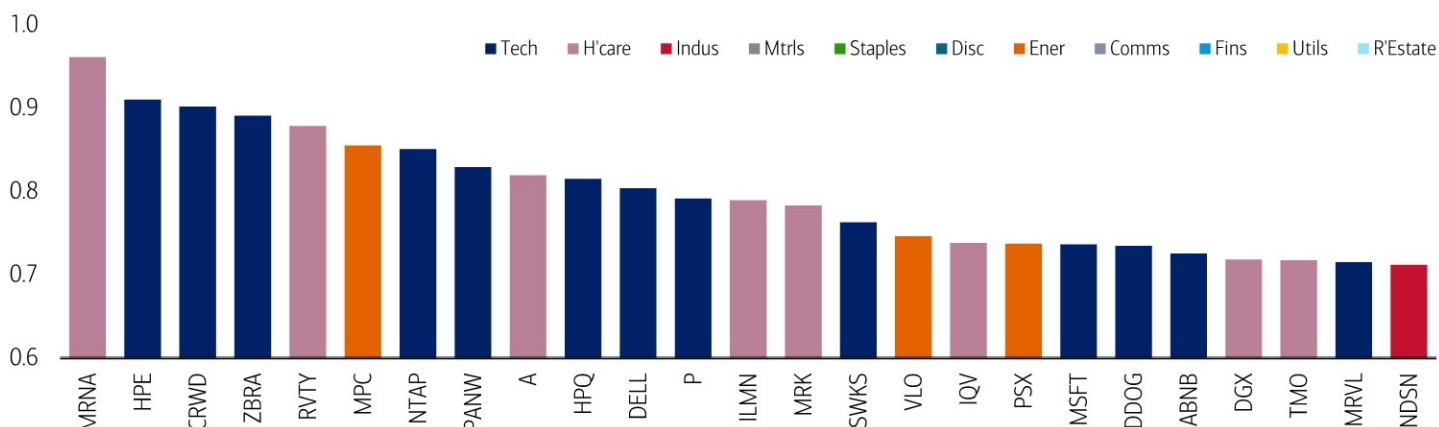


Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-95 to 02-Oct-26. Stocks' BRI computed using data since SPX inclusion. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Exhibit 13: Healthcare and tech stocks like MRNA, HPE, CRWD, ZBRA and RVTY rank highest in terms of their Bubble Risk Indicators amongst S&P 500 members

S&P 500 member stocks with highest BRI reading (as of 02-Oct-26)



Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 02-Oct-26. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8. Note that the BRI is a purely price-based metric intended to quantify the degree of bubble-like price action. It is not a fundamental view on the stock and should be used only as a complement to fundamental and positioning-based metrics.

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Exhibit 14: US cybersecurity, US healthcare momentum and JPY appreciation winners are amongst the global themes showing bubble-like price action as per their high BRIs

Bubble Risk Indicator on selected BofA Custom Baskets* (as of 02-Oct-26)

Basket	Ticker	BRI	Basket	Ticker	BRI	Basket	Ticker	BRI	Basket	Ticker	BRI
AMRS			US Stagflation	MLSTGFL8	0.18	Industrial Manufacturing	MLEINMAN	0.29	Japan Fiscal Impact	MLAPGEJP	0.30
US Cyber Security Basket	MLCYBRS	0.93	US Leisure Travel	MLDILEIS	0.17	European Reflation	MLD1REFL	0.29	Japan NISA	MLHKNISA	0.30
US Health Care Momentum Factor	MLUPHCMO	0.93	US Space Race	MLUSPACE	0.17	Gold Miners	MLD1GLDM	0.29	China AI Supply Chain	MLAPASC	0.28
US AI Compute	MLUCOMPU	0.75	US AI Adopters	MLUADOPT	0.17	EU High USD Exposure	MLEUAMER	0.28	Japan Cyclical	MLHKJPCY	0.27
US Pharma Hyperscalers Basket	MLURXHPY	0.75	US Consumer China Tariff Exposed	MLCTARIF	0.17	EU Cyclical	MLEUCYCL	0.28	Japan Domestic Upcycle	MLAPJDOB	0.24
US Software	MLUSOFT	0.72	US Foreign Revenue	MLFORER	0.16	UK Banks	MLD1UKBK	0.28	APAC Airline	MLHKFLYA	0.24
US AI Beneficiaries	MLUSAI	0.70	US Cyclical Industrials ex AI	MLUICXAI	0.16	EU Consensus Shorts	MLD1MSEU	0.27	Japan Inflation	MLHKJPIF	0.24
US Exporters	MLUXPORT	0.69	US Soft Landing	MLSLAND	0.15	EU stocks China expo	MLD1CHEX	0.27	Japan Industrials	MLAPJPIN	0.24
US Hardware	MLUSHRDW	0.68	US Quantum Computing	MLUQUANT	0.15	EU AI Adopters	MLEADOPT	0.27	APAC Oil exposed	MLAPOIL	0.24
US Beta Factor	MLUPBETA	0.65	US Private Credit Proxy	MLPRCRED	0.14	Italian Banks	MLEUITBK	0.27	Australian Mining	MLHKKAUMN	0.23
US AI Orchestra Basket	MLUAIORC	0.64	US Hard Landing	MLHLAND	0.13	EU Capital Goods	MLD1CAPG	0.27	Japan Engagement	MLAPJPAT	0.23
US TMT Memory Basket	MLUMEMOR	0.63	US Boomers Spend	MLUBOOM	0.13	EU Consensus Longs	MLD1LSEU	0.26	APAC Gold	MLAPGOLD	0.22
Brazil Election Basket	MLBZELEC	0.61	US Alternative Managers	MLUALTS	0.13	UK Domestic Names	MLUKDOMS	0.25	Japan High EM Exposure	MLHKHICH	0.21
US Staples Momentum Factor	MLUPSTMO	0.60	US Long Term Debt Maturities	MLLTMTAS	0.11	EU Travel Basket	MLD1TRAV	0.24	China Tariff	MLHKRPW2	0.20
US 800v DC Transition	MLUSOFT	0.58	US Commodities Complex	MLCOMMOD	0.10	EU Max Momo Top	MLEMOMOL	0.21	Japan Exporter to the US	MLAPJPEP	0.19
US High Quality Yield	MLHQYLD	0.58	US Private Equity Funds	MLDIPTPE	0.10	EU Tariff Exposed	MLETARIF	0.21	Korea Defense	MLHKKRDF	0.19
US TMT Supply Shortage	MLUTMTSP	0.57	US Building Products	MLUBUILD	0.10	EU Max Momo Bottom	MLEMOMOS	0.19	APAC Coal	MLAPCOAL	0.19
US TMT Durable Compounds	MLUTMTDC	0.57	US Defense, Energy, Infra & Security	MLDIHSEC	0.09	EU Ukraine Recovery	MLERBUKR	0.18	Korea Export ex Auto/Tech	MLKRREXP	0.18
US Commercial Biotech	MLUSCBIO	0.56	US Defense Technology	MLUDEFTC	0.09	EU Most Gas Exp	MLD1GASX	0.18	China Little Giants	MLHKCHLG	0.17
US Copper Exposed Basket	MLUSCOPP	0.55	US Old Economy	MLOLDEC	0.09	EU Stagflation	MLEUSTAG	0.17	Japan Corp Reform	MLHKJPRE	0.17
US Data Center Builders	MLUDATACB	0.54	US Consensus Small Cap Shorts	MLDIRSRT	0.09	EU HY Debt	MLEUDEBT	0.17	China Property	MLCHPROP	0.15
US SMID Cap Semis	MLSEMSM	0.54	US Generation Z Basket	MLUGENZ	0.08	EU Renewable Utilities	MLEURNEW	0.15	Japan GPIF	MLHKGPFI	0.15
US Momentum Factor	MLUPMOMO	0.53	US New Construction	MLNCONST	0.08	EU Security DEIS	MLEUDEIS	0.15	APAC Nuclear	MLHKNUCL	0.15
US Energy Momentum Factor	MLUPENMG	0.52	US Wellness Basket	MLUWELL	0.07	German Infrastructure	MLEGEINF	0.15	China Consumption Stimulus	MLAPCHST	0.13
US Residual Volatility Factor	MLUPVOLA	0.51	US Drone Ecosystem	MLUDRONE	0.07	EU Sovereign Priority	MLEUSOVR	0.14	Japan Retail	MLAPJRE	0.12
US Quality Factor	MLUPQUAL	0.50	US Power Supercycle	MLUSPOWR	0.06	EU Consumer Discretionary	MLEUCONS	0.13	China Consumer New	MLAPHKCN	0.10
US Cyclical Ex Commods	MLCYCLX	0.49	US High End Consumer	MLDIHEC	0.06	EU Exposed to US Consumer	MLEUSCON	0.13	China Robotics & AI	MLAPCHAI	0.09
US Value Factor	MLUPVALU	0.49	US Consumer Goods	MLGOODS	0.05	EU Defense	MLD1DEFE	0.12	Japan Sanaeconomics	MLAPJPISA	0.08
US AI Infrastructure	MLAIINFR	0.48	US GLP-1 Disruption Risk	MLXGLP1	0.05	EU Defense Electronics	MLEDEFEL	0.11	APAC AI Infrastructure	MLAPAIIF	0.08
US National Champions	MLUINCHAMP	0.44	US True Defensives	MLTRUDEF	0.05	EU Cyclical Exp to US	MLECYCUS	0.11	China Dual listed H-shares	MLHKPREM	0.07
US TMT Profitable Growth	MLUTMTPG	0.42	US Consumer Services	MLSERVE	0.05	EU Russia Exposed	MLEURUSS	0.10	Japan Defense	MLAPJDEF	0.06
US Discretionary Momentum Factor	MLUPCDMO	0.41	US Battery Ecosystem	MLUSBATT	0.04	Germany Domestic	MLEGEDOM	0.10	China National Brand	MLHKCBVM	0.05
US Managed Care	MLUMINGC	0.40	US Defense Contractors	MLDEFCON	0.04	EU European Domestic	MLEUDOMS	0.09	APAC EV	MLHKAPRN	0.04
US Efficient Growth	MLUEGROW	0.39	US Independent Power Producers (IPPs)	MLUIPPS	0.03	EU Defensives	MLEUDEFS	0.07	China OpenClaw	MLAPCLAW	0.03
US China Importers	MLCHIMPT	0.37	US Defense Electronics	MLUDELEC	0.02	French Domestic	MLD1FRAN	0.06	China Consumer Old	MLHKCHCO	0.03
US Low Income Spend	MLUSPREE	0.35	US Water Ecosystem	MLUH2O	0.02	EU M&A	MLEUMNAC	0.05	China Internet	MLHKCHIH	0.03
US Financials Momentum Factor	MLUPFINM	0.34	US Bond Proxy	MLEBOND	0.02	EU Autos	MLEUAUTO	0.04	Macau Gaming	MLHKMCGM	0.02
US Electric Grid Enablers	MLUGRID	0.34	US Utility Growth Basket	MLUSGUTE	0.01	EU Defence Exposed	MLEINDEF	0.04	Japan Wage Growth	MLHKJPWG	0.02
US LNG	MLUELNG	0.31	US Defensive Industrials	MLUDINDU	0.01	EU Luxury	MLEULUXG	0.02	Japan Tariff Exposed	MLAPJPTR	0.02
US Retail Signal	MLRETAIL	0.30	US TMT Defensives	MLUTMTDF	0.01	APAC			China Anti Involvement Basket	MLAPANTI	0.02
US EU Exposed	MLUSEURO	0.30	US Growth Factor	MLUPGROW	0.01	JPY Winners Appreciation	MLHKJPYA	0.82	Greater China Robotic	MLAPHUMA	0.02
US Transports	MLUTRANS	0.29	US Regulated Utilities	MLUREGU	0.00	APAC 5G	MLHKAP5G	0.76			
US Consensus Growth Shorts	MLDIMSGR	0.29	US Nuclear Energy Exposed	MLUSNUCL	0.00	China High Dividend Yield	MLAPCHDV	0.74			
US Materials Momentum Factor	MLUPMAMO	0.26	EMEA			APAC Shipping	MLAPSHIP	0.69			
Canada Infrastructure & Defense	MLCAINFR	0.26	EU Semis & Semicaps	MLD1EUSM	0.65	Taiwan AI basket	MLHKTWAI	0.65			
US TMT Momentum Factor	MLUPTMMO	0.26	Oil & Gas ex-Renewables	MLD1OILX	0.59	Axl Inflation	MLHKAXIF	0.63			
US PMI Sensitive Industrials	MLUINDUS	0.26	EU Memory	MLEUBYTE	0.58	APAC AI Beneficiaries	MLHKAPAI	0.58			
US No Landing	MLNLAND	0.25	EU Software	MLESOFTW	0.52	Korea Tourism	MLHKKRMT	0.57			
US Industrials Momentum Factor	MLUPINMO	0.25	EU Copper Miners	MLEUCOPP	0.48	JPY Winners Depreciation	MLHKJPFJ	0.51			
US Crypto Exposed	MLDICRYP	0.25	UK Consumer	MLD1UKCS	0.40	China SOEs	MLHKZSOE	0.50			
US Boosters (Cyclicals)	MLBOOSTR	0.23	EU Steel	MLESTEEL	0.40	APAC World Cup	MLAPWCUP	0.50			
US Domestic Revenue	MLDOMSTC	0.22	UK Housebuilders	MLUKHOME	0.38	China Technology Localization	MLHKCTLC	0.48			
US NeoCloud Basket	MLUNEOCL	0.22	EU Power Grids	MLEUGRID	0.36	APAC Smart Glasses	MLAPSMGL	0.45			
US Consensus High Beta Shorts	MLDIHBHS	0.21	EU AI Power Surge	MLESURGE	0.35	Korea Battery	MLKRBBATT	0.43			
US Hard Assets, Low Obsolesce (HALO)	MLUHALO	0.21	EU Cyclical Chems	MLECCHEM	0.33	Korea Corporate Reform	MLHKKRPB	0.42			
US Renewables	MLUSRNEW	0.21	EU Short Cycle Industrial	MLEINSCY	0.32	Japan Electric Power	MLJPTPEL	0.41			
US Refinance Risk	MLREFIN	0.20	UK M&A Candidates	MLUKMNAC	0.32	APAC Petrochem	MLAPCHEM	0.41			
US Consensus Large Cap Shorts	MLDISSRT	0.19	UK Doms ex-Homebuilders	MLUKDOMX	0.32	Korea Holdco	MLAPKRHO	0.39			
US High Default Risk	MLUHDFLX	0.19	EU HALO Basket	MLEUHALO	0.31	Japan Defensives	MLHKJPDF	0.36			
US Consensus Value Shorts	MLDIMSVL	0.18	EU New Energy Order	MLEUNEEO	0.31	Japan Mgmt Transformation	MLAPJACA	0.36			

Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 02-Oct-26. ***Disclaimer:** These BofA baskets are proprietary baskets structured and maintained by the BofA Securities trading desk. For more details on these baskets, please contact the team. See BRI disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Low breadth is a feature not a bug

Despite the continued surge in yields and bond market turmoil, the S&P and Nasdaq have remained resilient. However, they have done so with historically poor breadth (Exhibit 15), largely at the hands of megacap tech strength & AI-related FOMO in the face of macro headwinds.

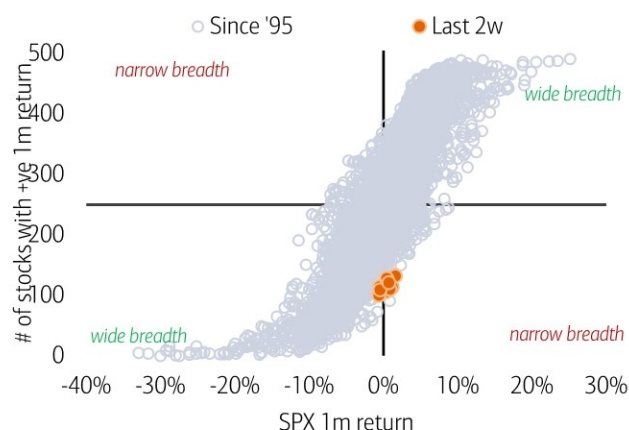
As we have outlined in recent weeks, macro risks face a high bar to derail US tech (see [29-Sep-26 GEVI](#)) as they fight for attention with AI's long-term potential, and the price action of the past week continues to validate this regime.

Strikingly, after last Friday's soft payroll print drove yields lower and equities higher, the tech-heavy Nasdaq remained resilient to close in the green despite yields retracing their move entirely (Exhibit 16). Such an asymmetric reaction function to bond yield moves appears unique to US tech, which has recently rallied ~3 times more on days when yields decline than it has rallied on days when yields rise (Exhibit 17). With other pockets of the market less immune to rates, this divergence is only adding further fuel to elevated dispersion levels.

The result has been a ~6% Nasdaq rally over the past month despite 10y yields rising ~50bps, with US tech's reaction function continuing to point to underlying bubble-like dynamics in the AI trade.

Exhibit 15: While the S&P has remained resilient to rising bond yields in recent weeks, it has done so with historically poor breadth

SPX rolling 1m returns vs number of S&P stocks with positive 1m returns

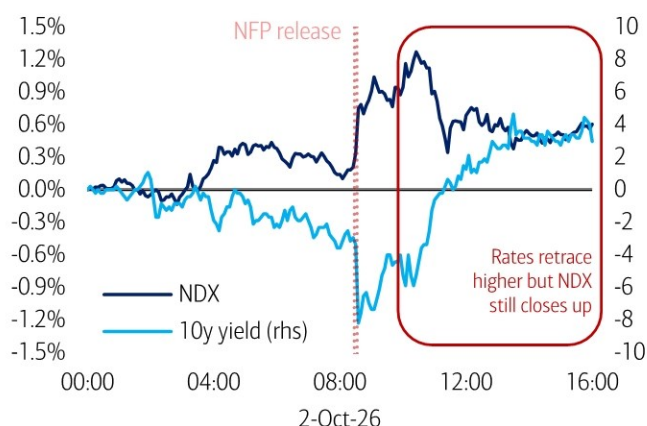


Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-95 to 02-Oct-26.

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Exhibit 16: Despite 10y yields retracing their entire soft NFP-driven move lower on 2-Oct, the Nasdaq stayed resilient to close in the green

Nasdaq 100 & 10y yields intraday performance on 2-Oct-26

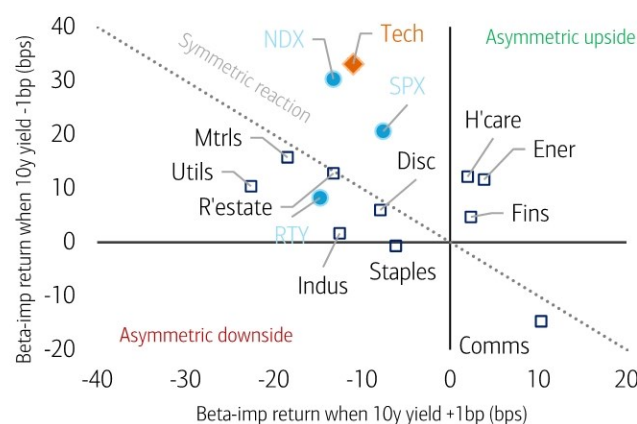


Source: BofA Global research, Bloomberg. 5-min data from 2-Oct-26.

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Exhibit 17: US tech has shown a unique asymmetry in its reaction function to 10y yields, rallying ~3x more on yields lower vs higher

Beta-implied return* when 10y yields +/- 1bp for US equity indices & sectors



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 2-Sep-26 to 2-Oct-26. Sectors are defined as per the Global Industry Classification Standard, along with re-classification of certain companies (primarily those not in tech that are largely internet/tech driven, e.g., Alphabet, Meta, Tesla, Amazon etc.).

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In our view, right tail risks continue to be the pertinent one in US equities, especially in US tech, as tech optimism overcomes macro and policy uncertainty. Indeed, realized vol on up days has far exceeded those on down days in the S&P and Nasdaq over the past month, largely driven by US tech's asymmetric reaction function to the upside (Exhibit 18).

To hedge further tech upside from here, we continue to view call spreads on the S&P or Nasdaq to be an attractive risk-limited expression, and benefit from a historically flat call skew entry point. For instance, QQQ Nov 40d/10d call spreads can offer >4x max payout ratios (~82nd %ile since 2012). To cheapen the premium outlay further, one can



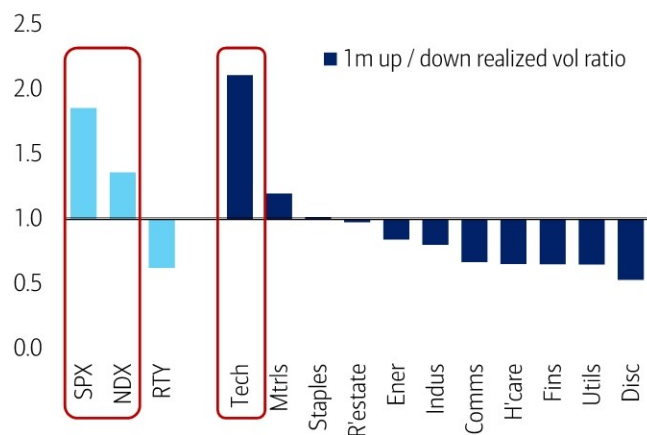
partially fund the call spreads with OTM puts (i.e., call spread collars); for instance, selling a 15d put (~8% OTM) can cheapen a 40d/10d call spread further by ~50%. Additionally, the increasingly spot-up, vol-up / spot-down, vol-down behaviour in US equities (Exhibit 19) makes structures like call spread collars even more attractive in today's regime.

Trade (QQQ call spread): Buy QQQ Nov26 775-825 call spread for \$11.63 indicatively (**4.3x max payout ratio**; ~40d/10d strikes; ref. 756.20). Risk involves upfront premium paid.

Another way we continue to like hedging tech upside amidst a turbulent macro backdrop is via NDX calls contingent on rates higher but range bound. These equity higher, rates higher hybrids can provide cheaper upside exposure while remaining limited-risk and play on a continuation of equities and rates trending higher together (as they have in recent months as well as in the late 90s Dotcom bubble).

Exhibit 18: Realized vol on up days is exceeding those on down days in the S&P and Nasdaq, which has been driven by US tech's asymmetric reaction function to the upside

Upside-to-downside 1m realized vol ratio for US equity indices & sectors

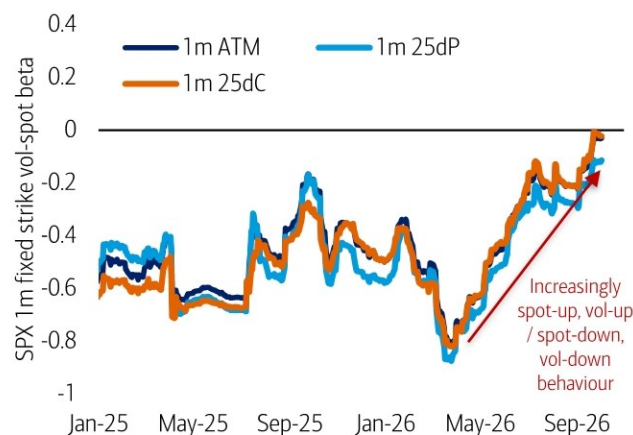


Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 2-Oct-26. Sectors are defined as per the Global Industry Classification Standard, along with re-classification of certain companies (primarily those not in tech that are largely internet/tech driven, e.g., Alphabet, Meta, Tesla, Amazon etc.).

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Exhibit 19: SPX vol has increasingly shown spot-up, vol-up / spot-down, vol-down behaviour, especially on the call side, as seen by the fixed strike vol-spot beta trending steadily towards 0

SPX 1m fixed strike vol-spot beta* for 1m ATMf, 25dP and 25dC strikes



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-25 to 2-Oct-26. *1m realized beta of daily changes in 1m fixed strike vol and daily returns in equities.

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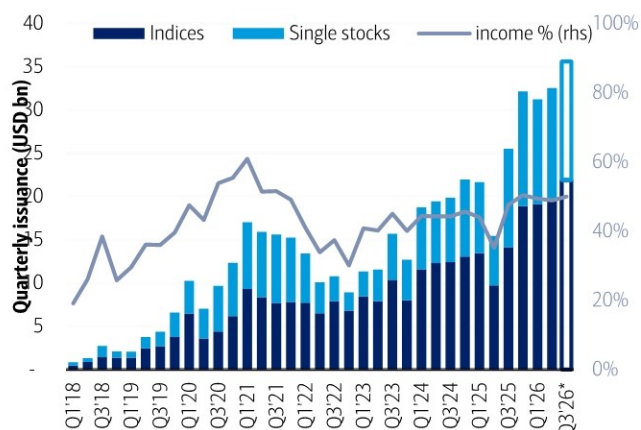
Autocallification increasingly shaping vol dynamics, supports case for calendars

The structural growth of derivatives income is increasingly leaving its mark on volatility markets. In our recent report, [When Income became an Outcome](#), we argued that demand is being supported by a broader appetite for cash flow, income diversification beyond bonds, higher equity volatility, product innovation and the growing mainstream adoption of options. Here, we quantify this growth and consider its impact on pricing of derivatives. Momentum in income structured-product issuance has continued growing in Q3'26 in North American underlyings, where it is on track for another record quarter at ~\$35bn on a pro-rated basis, still largely driven by index-linked products (Exhibit 20). In EMEA, issuance has eased from its Q1'26 peak of more than \$40bn, while single-stock products continue to drive activity and income structures now account for a growing ~60% share of issuance (Exhibit 21).

Among index underlyings, issuance remains concentrated in SPX, RTY, NDX and SX5E, with Q3 issuance of ~\$6.5bn in SPX products and ~\$5bn in RTY (Exhibit 22). Among single stocks, NVDA continues to lead by a wide margin, with more than \$8bn of issuance YTD, while MU, ORCL and GEV have seen the sharpest acceleration, running at more than 4x their 2025 pace (Exhibit 23).

Exhibit 20: Income issuance continues to accelerate in North America, with growth still primarily driven by index-linked products.

Quarterly issuance of income structured products in North America, across both index- and single stock-linked products. Income issuance as a share of total ELS issuance in North America.

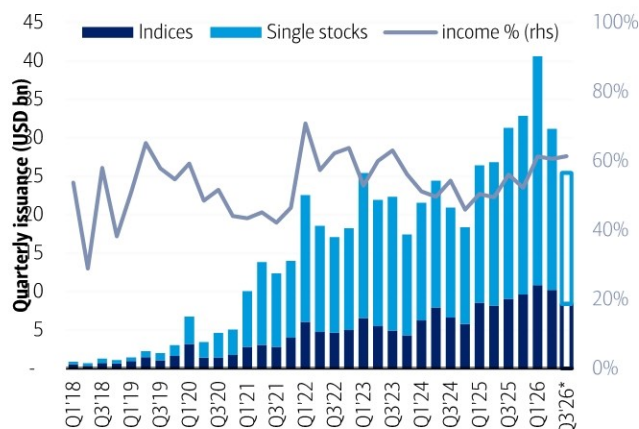


Source: BofA Global Research, SPI part of WSD. Data as of 30-Sep-26. For multi-underlying structures, we allocate notional equally across all constituents by dividing the total notional by the number of underlyings and assigning the resulting amount to each underlying. Structured products reported here exclude open-ended products and warrants. *Q3'26 figures are pro-rated using issuance observed in Jul26 and Aug26.

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Exhibit 21: EMEA income issuance appears lower vs Q1'26, with activity driven broadly by single-stock products. Income structures continue to account for a higher share of issuance in EMEA.

Quarterly issuance of income structured products in EMEA, across both index- and single stock-linked products. Income issuance as a share of total ELS issuance in EMEA.

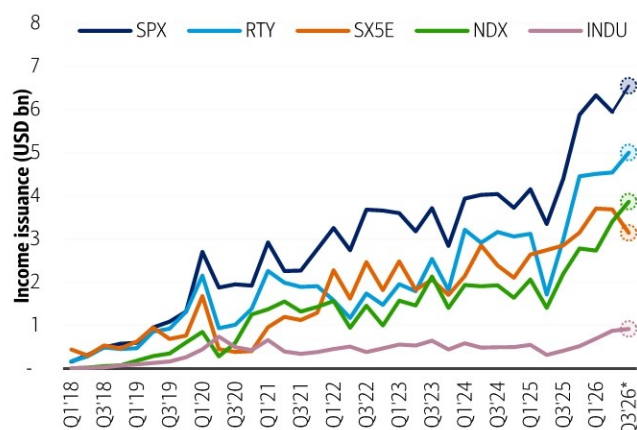


Source: BofA Global Research, SPI part of WSD. Data as of 30-Sep-26. For multi-underlying structures, we allocate notional equally across all constituents by dividing the total notional by the number of underlyings and assigning the resulting amount to each underlying. Structured products reported here exclude open-ended products and warrants. *Q3'26 figures are pro-rated using issuance observed in Jul26 and Aug26.

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Exhibit 22: Global index-linked income issuance is concentrated in SPX, RTY, NDX, SX5E and INDU

Top 5 indices with the highest YTD income issuance (USD bn) across North America and EMEA, based on cumulative issuance from Jan through Aug.

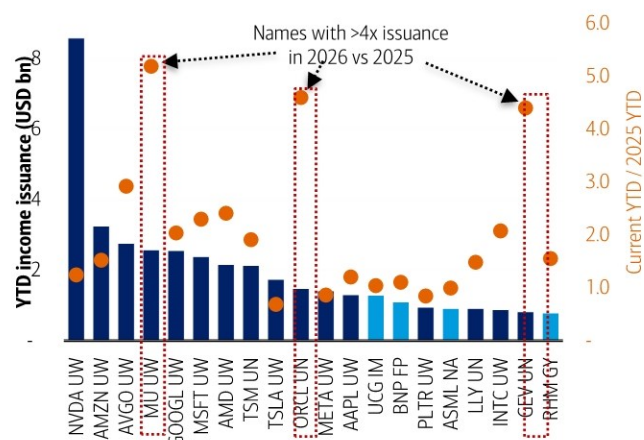


Source: BofA Global Research, SPi part of WSD. Data as of 30-Sep-26. *Q3'26 figures are pro-rated using issuance observed in Jul26 and Aug26.

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Exhibit 23: NVDA leads single-stock income issuance by a wide margin. Micron, Oracle, and GE Vernova are running at more than 4x their 2025 issuance pace

Top 20 stocks by YTD income issuance (USD bn) across North America and EMEA, based on cumulative issuance from Jan through Aug. The RHS axis shows current YTD income issuance as a percentage of the corresponding YTD level last year.



Source: BofA Global Research, SPi part of WSD. Data as of 30-Sep-26.

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Dealer positioning points to peak vol dampening

Following strong equity performance this year, spot is now close to peak Vanna across all four major indices. Dealer Greek profiles from live structured products show SPX, SX5E, NDX and RTY trading within 2%-7% of peak Vanna (Exhibits 24-27). At these levels, the vol-dampening effect of dealer hedging is likely close to its strongest. The significance of these flows, however, depends on the depth of each listed options market. In SPX, the market's depth dilutes the impact, with structured-product flows equivalent to only ~6% of daily listed Vega traded. That share rises to ~18% in SX5E and ~36% in NDX. In RTY, it exceeds a full day of listed Vega turnover, at up to ~185%. This suggests NDX and RTY are potentially the most "autocallified" of the major benchmarks.

Fixed-strike vol-spot correlations have also become increasingly positive across all four indices (Exhibit 28). NDX leads at 52.5%, followed by SX5E at 42.5%, RTY at 42.3% and SPX at 35.4% (Exhibit 29). Notably, SPX correlation turned positive only a few weeks ago, having bucked the broader trend earlier this year. This dealer vol supply and associated vol dampening can also contribute to flatter put skew, as currently seen in SX5E and NDX, where skew stands at its 7.8th and 13.4th 3y percentiles, respectively.

Idiosyncratic stock vol is also impacted by hedging dynamics

Among the top 20 names by issuance, semis and US tech show the strongest autocallification characteristics. INTC (67.6%), AMD (64.9%), TSM (61.3%), AVGO (57.8%) and AAPL (56.7%) screen at the top based on recent fixed-strike vol-spot correlation (Exhibit 29). By contrast, European names such as UCG, BNP and RHM show low or slightly negative correlations, despite sizeable issuance.

Overall, NDX, SX5E and RTY screen among the top indices on this spot-vol correlation measure, while INTC, AMD, TSM, AVGO and AAPL lead among single stocks. Notably, peak Vega still sits ~30%-65% below spot for these names, leaving a significant buffer before spot-vol correlations turn negative on account of dealer hedging dynamics.

Autocallified long-dated vol can fund near-term gamma

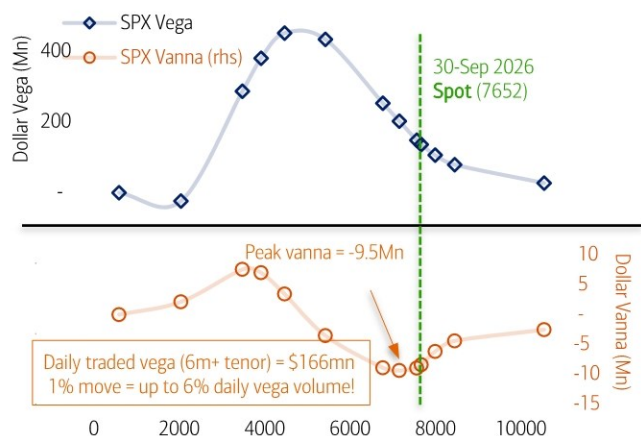
The vol dampening effect described above can make longer-dated vols on autocallified underlyings a suitable short vol leg to finance the purchase of shorter-dated long vol trades i.e. long gamma, short vega trades. This may be particularly relevant in the



current environment, where positioning-related dislocations, like those seen during summer 2026, create the potential for episodic spikes in realised volatility. Long gamma trades may be better suited to benefit from heightened realised volatility around large positioning clean-ups, structural rebalancing pressures in leveraged positions, while having a funding leg can ease carry costs associated with low levels of realised volatility in the absence of sporadic fragility events.

Exhibit 24: Peak vanna in SPX sits ~7% below spot; structured product hedging flow accounts for only ~6% of daily listed vega traded

Vega/Vanna profile of live SPX-linked structured products

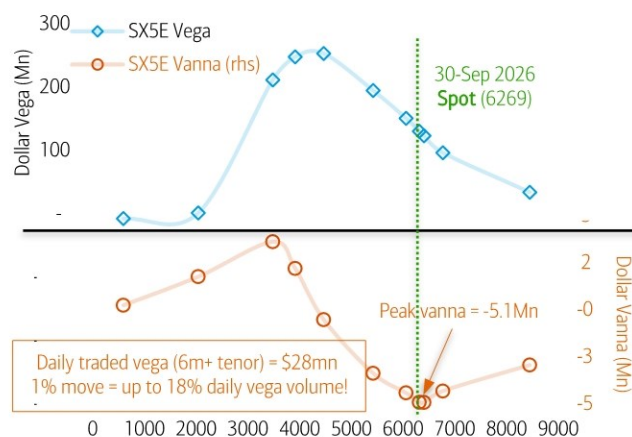


Source: BofA Global Research, SPi, part of WSD, Bloomberg. Vega is derived from the universe of products live as of 29-Sep-26. Vanna is calculated using adjacent Vega values. Daily traded Vega is defined as the median daily traded Vega volume over the past month.

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Exhibit 25: Peak vanna in SX5E sits ~2% above current spot

Vega/Vanna profile of live SX5E-linked structured products

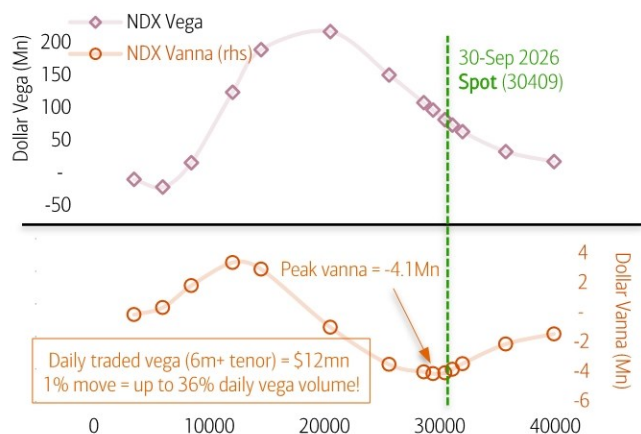


Source: BofA Global Research, SPi, part of WSD, Bloomberg. Vega is derived from the universe of products live as of 29-Sep-26. Vanna is calculated using adjacent Vega values. Daily traded Vega is defined as the median daily traded Vega volume over the past month.

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Exhibit 26: Peak vanna in NDX sits ~3% below current spot, and represents roughly ~36% of the daily (listed) vega traded

Vega/Vanna profile of live NDX-linked structured products

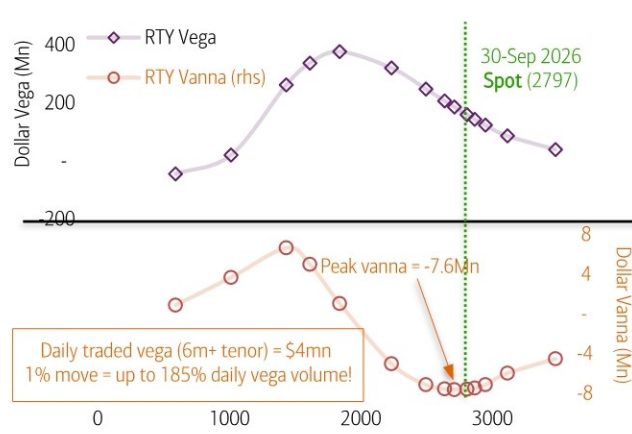


Source: BofA Global Research, SPi, part of WSD, Bloomberg. Vega is derived from the universe of products live as of 29-Sep-26. Vanna is calculated using adjacent Vega values. Daily traded Vega is defined as the median daily traded Vega volume across NDX and QQQ US over the past month.

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Exhibit 27: Peak vanna in RTY sits ~3% below current spot, while it represents more than the daily listed Vega turnover

Vega/Vanna profile of live RTY-linked structured products

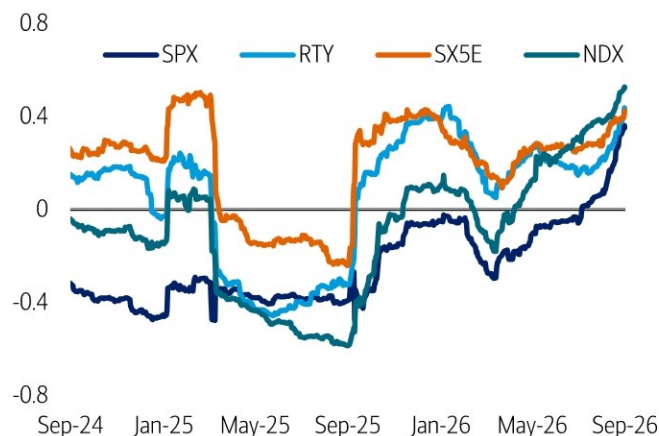


Source: BofA Global Research, SPi, part of WSD, Bloomberg. Vega is derived from the universe of products live as of 29-Sep-26. Vanna is calculated using adjacent Vega values. Daily traded Vega is defined as the median daily traded Vega volume across RTY and IWM US over the past month.

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Exhibit 28: NDX, RTY, SX5E and SPX exhibit some of the strongest recent signs of autocallification via rising spot-vol correl

Fixed strike vol–spot correlation*



Source: BofA Global Research Data, Bloomberg from 30-Sep-24 to 30-Sep-26. *6m correlation between spot and 2y 80% fixed strike vol.

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Exhibit 29: Indices and stocks exhibiting the strongest impact of autocallification via recent fixed-strike vol-spot correlations

Indices and stocks with the largest income issuance YTD (as in Exhibit 22 and 23) ranked in descending order of recent fixed-strike vol-spot correlation*

		Implied vol rank		Autocallification impact rank			Peak Vega distance rank	
		Sector	2y 80% ^f IV	IV 3y %-ile	2y Put skew (80/100% ^f IV ratio)	Put Skew 3y %-ile	Latest 6m fixed strike vol-spot correl* (Rank)	Distance from Peak Vega ** (%)
NDX		26.2%	73%	1.15	13.4%	52.5% (1)	-32.6%	-3.3%
SX5E		21.6%	70%	1.24	7.8%	42.5% (2)	-28.8%	2.1%
RTY		24.1%	39%	1.15	58.5%	42.3% (3)	-34.3%	-3.1%
SPX		22.1%	58%	1.28	34.6%	35.4% (4)	-41.7%	-6.5%
INDU		19.7%	64%	1.24	4.7%	-5.7% (5)	-37.2%	-12.4%
INTC UW	IT	65.8%	88%	0.99	12.4%	67.6% (1)	-65.7%	-23.5%
AMD UW	IT	55.9%	74%	1.00	7.6%	64.9% (2)	-60.3%	-20.6%
TSM UN	IT	40.3%	47%	1.01	13.8%	61.3% (3)	-33.5%	-7.3%
AVGO UW	IT	44.6%	56%	1.00	1.9%	57.8% (4)	-30.9%	34.5%
AAPL UW	IT	28.8%	55%	1.06	5.3%	56.7% (5)	-48.4%	-18.5%
MU UW	IT	57.6%	69%	0.99	0.5%	55.5% (6)	-44.6%	7.7%
LLY UN	Health Care	38.6%	80%	1.00	0.0%	55.5% (7)	-34.6%	1.9%
META UW	Comm Svcs	43.1%	96%	1.00	0.3%	53.0% (8)	-27.2%	1.5%
GEV UN	Industrials	50.5%	63%	1.00	1.3%	47.4% (9)	-38.0%	20.7%
PLTR UW	IT	58.0%	29%	1.00	5.7%	41.2% (10)	-31.4%	4.0%
GOOGL UW	Comm Svcs	36.3%	71%	1.02	11.3%	39.4% (11)	-29.4%	-4.3%
AMZN UW	Discretionary	36.0%	67%	1.01	8.8%	39.3% (12)	-37.5%	3.0%
TSLA UW	Discretionary	46.3%	0%	1.01	51.1%	36.5% (13)	-14.6%	33.1%
ORCL UN	IT	56.7%	84%	1.00	1.7%	35.7% (14)	8.9%	41.7%
NVDA UW	IT	39.9%	0%	1.02	56.8%	33.8% (15)	-36.8%	-3.5%
UCG IM	Financials	33.5%	30%	1.07	1.8%	13.0% (16)	-36.2%	-3.4%
ASML NA	IT	42.8%	82%	1.00	0.7%	1.5% (17)	-52.6%	12.0%
BNP FP	Financials	31.6%	83%	1.10	14.4%	-0.1% (18)	-32.5%	5.3%
RHM GY	Industrials	41.4%	62%	1.02	51.5%	-0.1% (19)	19.9%	49.7%
MSFT UW	IT	33.4%	87%	1.02	5.9%	-3.0% (20)	-39.2%	-2.6%

Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg, SPI, part of WSD. Data from 29-Sep-23 to 30-Sep-26. *Latest 6m correlation between spot and 2y 80% fixed strike vol, data as of 30-Sep-26. **We use Peak Vega reference as of 29-Sep-26 for indices and as of 30-Aug-26 for single names.

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Frequently asked questions about the BofA Bubble Risk Indicator (BRI)

In our [2026 Year Ahead report](#), we introduced the BofA Bubble Risk Indicator (BRI), a price-based measure designed to detect bubble-like instability across financial assets. Given strong client interest, we are now adding a weekly one-page BRI update to the GEVI (see earlier pages). This update will track BRI levels across major markets and asset classes, highlight pockets of equities exhibiting the most froth, and call out recent increases in bubble-like price action. Below, we address some of the most frequently asked questions about the BRI.

The BofA Bubble Risk Indicator is intended to be an indicative metric only and may not be used for reference purposes or as a measure of performance for any financial instrument or contract, or otherwise relied upon by third parties for any other purpose, without the prior written consent of BofA Global Research. The BRI was not created to act as a benchmark.

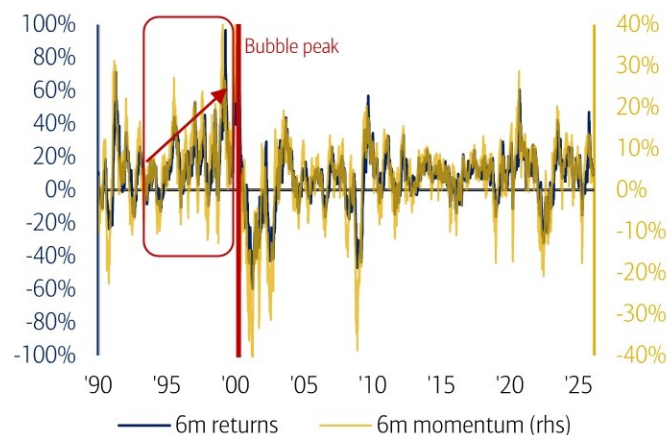
1. How does the BRI quantify 'bubble risk'?

A defining feature of historical asset bubbles is that volatility tends to rise alongside prices. Building on this observation and drawing inspiration from how the four statistical moments characterize a distribution, the BRI quantifies bubble risk using the first four moments of an asset's price action: (i) returns, (ii) realized volatility, (iii) price momentum¹, and (iv) fragility/convexity.²

These four moments typically become elevated during the frothiest phases of asset bubbles, reflecting the influence of exuberant sentiment, one-sided positioning and imbalanced supply-demand dynamics on price action. The late 90s dotcom bubble in the Nasdaq provides a clear and pertinent illustration of these dynamics (Exhibit 30 & Exhibit 31).

Exhibit 30: Both price returns and price momentum of the Nasdaq rose as the dotcom bubble inflated

NDX 6m price returns and 6m price momentum

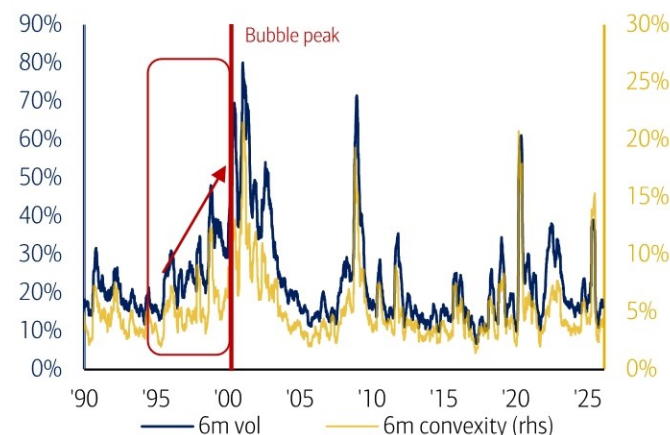


Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-90 to 16-Jan-26.

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Exhibit 31: Nasdaq's vol and fragility also rose into the peak of the dotcom bubble as tech stock price rose

NDX 6m realized vol and 6m realized convexity



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-90 to 16-Jan-26.

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2. How is the BRI constructed?

The BRI is constructed as an average of three sub-indicators: a short-term, medium-term, and long-term measure. Each sub-indicator ranges from 0 to 1. Using multiple time horizons allows the indicator to capture bubble-risk dynamics that can develop at different speeds.

¹ X-month price momentum = % distance of the current price from the X-month moving average price

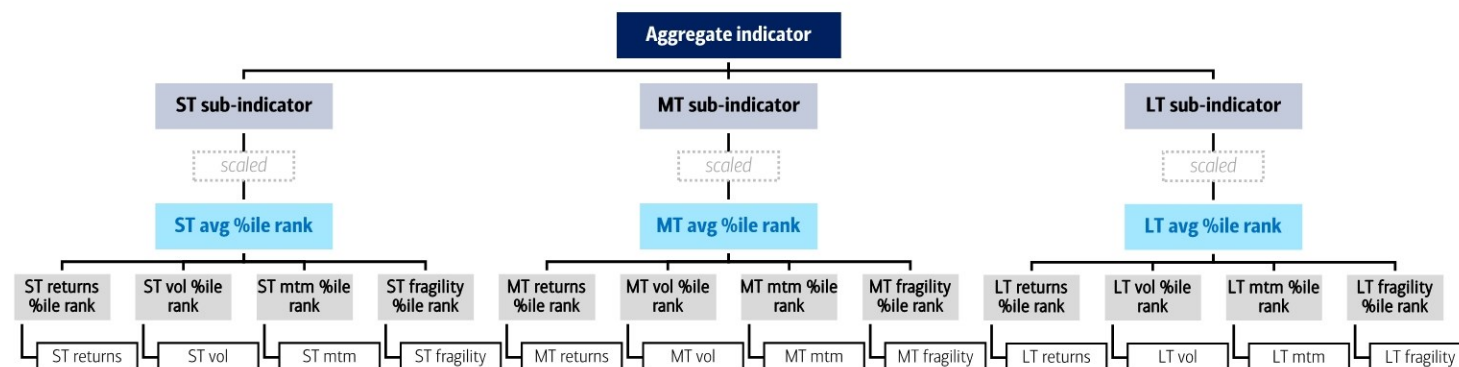
² X-month fragility/convexity = X-month realized vol – X-month realized mean absolute deviation

Each sub-indicator aims to capture how stretched an asset's four moments (returns, vol, momentum, and fragility) are relative to the asset's own history, and is computed as the average of each of these four moments' percentile ranks vs history.³ However, given detection of bubble-like behaviour is the primary aim of the indicator, we condition this average percentile rank on periods when the asset is rallying by scaling it up or down depending on how positive or negative returns are.⁴

Exhibit 32 summarizes the construction of the aggregate indicator and its microstructure.

Exhibit 32: The aggregate indicator is an average of 3 sub-indicators that capture short-, medium- and long-term price dynamics. Each sub-indicator is computed as a scaled average percentile rank of the four metrics (returns, vol, momentum & fragility)

Construction summary of BofA Bubble Risk Indicator



Source: BofA Global Research. ST, MT & LT refer to short-, medium- & long-term; 'mtn' refers to momentum component; '%ile rank' refers to percentile rank.

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3. What is a 'high' BRI reading and what are its implications?

Since the BRI is defined on a 0 to 1 scale, assets with readings approaching 1 are exhibiting increasingly bubble-like price action. How close to 1? While it is difficult to specify a universal threshold given the plethora of asset-specific dynamics that can present in markets, we find that BRI levels above 0.8 (i.e., top quintile) provide a useful rule of thumb beyond which bubble risks are likely elevated.

Tactically, high BRI readings tend to signal asymmetric downside risk in the near-term (higher risk of the bubble 'popping'), which we demonstrate empirically later in this section. However, rather than treating the BRI as an explicit sell signal ("get out"), which can risk major underperformance in a bubble, we find the BRI best positioned as a cautionary tool to add asymmetric protection/equity replacement ("watch out").

4. What assets can the BRI be computed on?

Given the BRI relies only on price-based inputs, it can be computed on any asset with a sufficient history of daily price data. Indeed, by inferring sentiment and positioning from price action, the BRI can be applied to assets without explicit fundamental valuation methodologies (e.g., commodities) or those with opaque positioning visibility.

5. What has the BRI looked like in past asset bubbles?

Exhibit 33 demonstrates what the BRI framework would have looked like when applied to eight historically well-recognized asset bubbles. As these bubbles formed, increasingly stretched returns, vol, momentum, and fragility pushed BRI readings towards 1. Indeed, seven of the eight bubbles saw their peaks concurrent to a BRI reading above 0.8.

³ Sub-indicator parameters in this report: (i) short-term = 3m moments vs 1y %ile rank lookback, (ii) medium-term = 6m moments vs 3y %ile rank lookback, (iii) long-term = 1y moments vs 5y %ile rank lookback. These parameters are for illustrative purposes and may differ in their efficacy depending on the dynamics of the asset being analyzed.

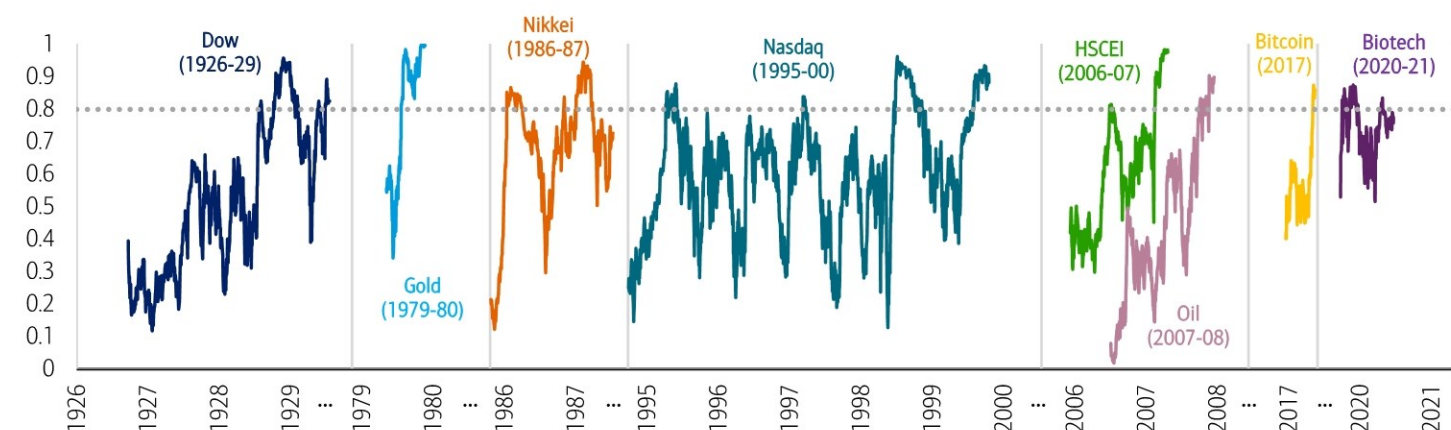
⁴ Scaling factor ranges between 0 & 1. It is computed using a logistic function transformation of the trailing return (tenor based on sub-indicator). Highly positive returns give a factor of ~1 and highly negative returns give a factor of ~0.



The forward distribution of returns during these bubbles conditional on the BRI would have shown higher near-term downside risk after the BRI breached 0.8 (Exhibit 34), with broadly similar upside potential (Exhibit 35).

Exhibit 33: Looking at eight historical asset bubbles from a distributional lens using the BRI methodology reveals increasingly elevated returns, vol, momentum and fragility in the asset bubble formation process, as seen by rising levels of the indicator towards 1

BofA Bubble Risk Indicator during historical asset bubbles

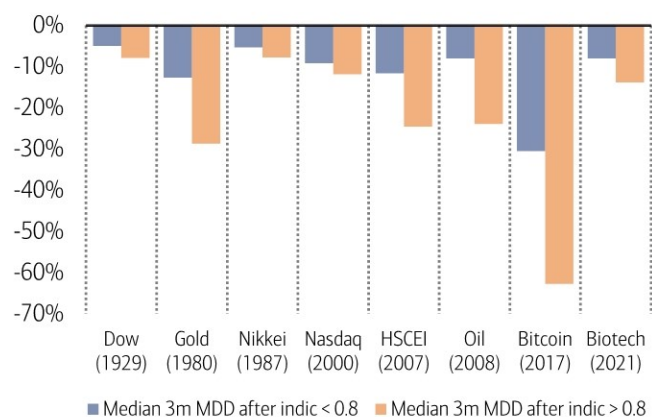


Source: BofA Global Research. Data from Jan-1926 to Feb-2021. Underlying Bloomberg tickers: INDU for Dow (Oct-1926 to Sep-1929), XAU for Gold (Jul-1979 to Jan-1980), NKY for Nikkei (Jan-1986 to Oct-1987), NDX for Nasdaq (Jan-1995 to Mar-2000), HSCEI for HSCEI (Jun-2006 to Oct-2007), CO1 for Oil (Jan-2007 to Jul-2008), XBTUSD for Bitcoin (Jul-2017 to Dec-2017), SPSIBI for Biotech (May-2020 to Feb-2021).

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Exhibit 34: The median 3m max draw-down following indicator readings above 0.8 would have been more adverse than when below 0.8 during historical asset bubbles

Median 3m max draw-down during historical asset bubbles (i) after indicator < 0.8, (ii) after indicator ≥ 0.8

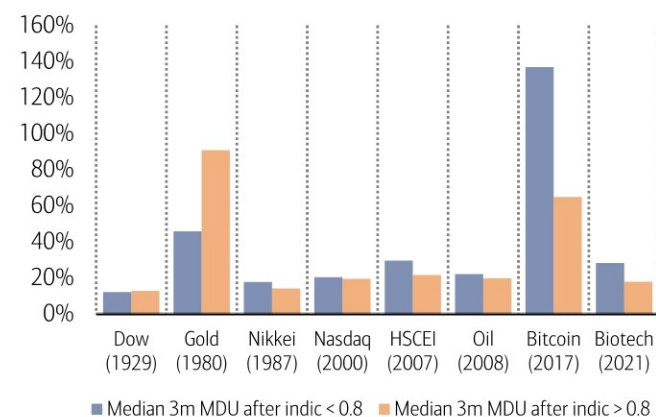


Source: BofA Global Research. Underlying tickers / date ranges: INDU for Dow (Oct-1926 to Sep-1929), XAU for Gold (Jul-1979 to Jan-1980), NKY for Nikkei (Jan-1986 to Oct-1987), NDX for Nasdaq (Jan-1995 to Mar-2000), HSCEI for HSCEI (Jun-2006 to Oct-2007), CO1 for Oil (Jan-2007 to Jul-2008), XBTUSD for Bitcoin (Jul-2017 to Dec-2017), SPSIBI for Biotech (May-2020 to Feb-2021).

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Exhibit 35: The median 3m max draw-up would have been similar at both high and low indicator readings, suggesting that de-risking completely following high indicator levels can risk underperformance

Median 3m max draw-up during historical asset bubbles (i) after indicator < 0.8, (ii) after indicator ≥ 0.8



Source: BofA Global Research. Underlying tickers / date ranges: INDU for Dow (Oct-1926 to Sep-1929), XAU for Gold (Jul-1979 to Jan-1980), NKY for Nikkei (Jan-1986 to Oct-1987), NDX for Nasdaq (Jan-1995 to Mar-2000), HSCEI for HSCEI (Jun-2006 to Oct-2007), CO1 for Oil (Jan-2007 to Jul-2008), XBTUSD for Bitcoin (Jul-2017 to Dec-2017), SPSIBI for Biotech (May-2020 to Feb-2021).

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6. Can an asset with a high BRI reading not be in a bubble?

Yes. One of the risks stemming from the BRI's exclusive use of price data is instances of 'false positives' when the indicator appears stressed, but the asset doesn't appear to be in a bubble based on other metrics. For example, semiconductor stocks exhibited frothy behaviour in the immediate aftermath of ChatGPT's release in Nov-22 but also saw a fundamental shift and expansion of their business model in the AI era.

Another scenario of a high BRI level that may not point to a bubble is in the immediate aftermath of an exogenous shock (e.g., COVID), where vol/fragility remain high and prices are retracing their drawdown. In such cases, the interpretation of a high BRI level requires additional context.

7. Can an asset in a bubble have a low BRI reading?

Yes. A related limitation of the BRI's reliance on price data is the implicit assumption that the asset bubble in question would result in historically elevated instability. While the typical evolution of a bubble sees this happen as stretched positioning and exuberance translate into volatile & fragile rallies with high momentum into the peak, outlier cases where the bubble peak sees the bull run end in a whimper can occur and are a challenge for the BRI (e.g., the Nikkei bubble in the 1980s, which saw its most unstable rally earlier rather than later).

8. How can one use the short-term to long-term sub-indicators of the BRI?

As discussed above, the BRI aggregates short-term, medium-term, and long-term sub-indicators to capture asset price dynamics across multiple horizons. In addition to examining the sub-indicators to understand shorter vs longer-term trends, we also find the range across sub-indicators provides a confidence level on the BRI reading, with tighter ranges providing higher confidence. For example, a 0.7 BRI reading is likely more informative when the sub-indicators span 0.6 to 0.8 than when they range from 0.4 to 1.0, where disagreement across horizons suggests greater uncertainty.

9. What other indicators can help confirm elevated bubble risk?

At its core, the BRI is simply a parsimonious transformation of prices, avoiding a “kitchen-sink” approach that incorporates explicit positioning, leverage, or PB data. This keeps the framework robust to overfitting and makes it applicable across assets, regions, and historical periods where such data are often unavailable or unreliable.

Despite the appeal of such an approach, we find the BRI most effective when used in conjunction with complementary tools that can help assess whether frothy price action is supported by fundamentals – for example, more traditional valuation (e.g., PV of cash flows, valuation multiples, etc.) and/or positioning metrics (e.g., leverage, inflows, retail trading volumes etc.) where available.

10. What universe of assets will be covered in the BofA BRI Landscape?

We plan to include BRI levels on a broad set of assets covering global equity indices, large cap US equity sector indices (including the “Magnificent 7”), major commodities (including the BCOM Index), and major cryptocurrencies (Bitcoin and Ethereum). In addition to this core cross-asset universe, we plan to apply the BRI framework to popular equity themes that have experienced significant inflows over the prior week. This thematic lens is designed to spot emerging pockets of froth that may not yet be visible at the broader index or sector level.



Summary of Open Trades (05-Oct-26)

Price data for open level reflects the price on open date and does not necessarily reflect the price at which the trade could be executed at the date of this report. Our trades are structured to be executed on the open date and are not necessarily appropriate to execute as formulated beyond that date.

Table 1: Summary of open trades as of 05-Oct-26

Summary of open trades as of 05-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Expected Trade Term	Rationale
Buy an SX5E Dec26 5000 call (for 9% indic., spot ref 4895, 45delta, 62bps vega), initially delta-hedged	5-Mar-24	9%	Dec-26	Don't miss a generational opportunity to lock in record low long-dated EU vol
Buy an SX5E Dec26 5000 call (for 9% indic., spot ref 4895, 45delta, 62bps vega), initially delta-hedged	05-Mar-24	9%	Dec-26	Attractive opportunity to lock in record low long-dated EU vol
Replicate a NKY Dec25-Dec26 36.5K FVA straddle with a static strip of options at an implied FVA level of 18.6. To trade US\$100k vega	9-Sep-24	18.6v	Dec26	Long discounted Nikkei vol: Fixed strike Dec-25/Dec-26 FVA straddles at 18.6%
Trade (SPX upvar): Buy SPX Dec26 80% upvar for 18.45v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 24.55v; fwd ref. 5551).	28-Apr-25	18.45v	Dec26	Position for spot up, vol up which leverage elevated tail skew and inverted term structure
Trade (SPX fwd upvar): Buy SPX Dec25/Dec26 80% fwd upvar for 17v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; fwd var ref. 23.6v; fwd ref. 5551).	28-Apr-25	17v	Dec26	Position for spot up, vol up which leverage elevated tail skew and inverted term structure
Long SPX 2028 annual dividend futures/short SPX 2026 annual dividend futures for \$1.15 net indicatively	6-May-25	\$1.15	Dec26	Position for the normalization of the dividend futures curve as time moves towards maturity and dividend growth is priced back in
Long SX5E Dec26 dividends, vs short SPX Dec26 dividends.	6-May-25	\$0.00	Dec26	Dec26 dividends are more heavily discounted for SX5E than for SPX, despite what we view as higher earnings risk in SPX companies, relative to SX5E
Buy SPX Dec26 110% upvar for 11.25v indic. (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 23v; fwd ref. 5915)	2-Jun-25	11.25v	Dec26	Hedge upside pain with long delta, long vol positions that leverage elevated long-dated tail skew
Buy SPX Dec25Dec26 110% fwd upvar for 11.36v indic. (t & t-1 convention; fwd var ref. 23.3v; fwd ref. 5915).	2-Jun-25	11.36v	Dec26	Hedge upside pain with long delta, long vol positions that leverage elevated long-dated tail skew
Buy SPX Dec26 ATM upvar for 12.2v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 22.5v)	11-Aug-25	12.2v	Dec26	Leverage record steep tail skew to enter into long vol positions via upvar
Sell SPX Dec26 var, buy SPX Dec26 60% upvar, to collect 3.5v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 22.5v)	11-Aug-25	3.5v	Dec26	Leverage record steep tail to enter into carry trade via upvar vs var
Sell SX5E Dec26 var, buy SX5E Dec26 60% upvar, to collect 3.1v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 21v).	18-Aug-25	3.1v	Dec 26	Vol-focused? Collect >3v on SX5E Upvar vs Var
Buy 1-year 105% 130% call spreads on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 3.52% (18d, 29v both legs). Consider fully financing the trade by selling 1-year 73.5% puts (37d, 29v calls vs 29.5v put)	13-Sep-25	3.52%	Oct-26	The low-cost/low risk way to buy China – deeply discounted call spreads
Buy SPX Dec26 ATM upvar for 13.95v indicatively (10v disc to vanilla; t & t-1 convention; Dec26 var ref. 24v).	3-Nov-25	13.95v	Dec26	Own spot-up, vol-up exposure as AI bubble continues to inflate.
Buy Dec26 80% put on basket of HYG (38%), SPX (29%), XLF (29%) & EEM (4%) for 1.46% (27% cheaper vs avg of individual legs)	26-Nov-25	1.46%	18-Dec-26	The convergence of private and public market risk creates opportunities for hedging private risk with liquid, public market hedges. Crucially, stress in public assets closely linked to private markets may ultimately impact private valuations, while potential hedge gains will give investors the flexibility to add risk at better terms.
Buy a basket of Dec26 90-70 put spreads on individual underlyings: SPX (53%), XLF (32%), TLT (9%) & EEM (6%) for 2.66% (weighted max payout ratio of put spreads is 7.7x)	26-Nov-25	2.66%	18-Dec-26	Given the higher volatility of the PE hedge constituents and significant decorrelation potential, we prefer buying put spreads on individual constituents rather than on the basket
Buy NDX Dec26 ATM upvar, currently 19.1v but target an entry level closer to 17v (t & t-1 convention, var ref. 29.9v)	26-Nov-25	19.1v / target 17v	18-Dec-26	Trade long-delta, long vol via upvar to capture the spot-up, vol-up typically seen in asset bubbles, with a deep discount to vanilla var
Buy long-dated OTM puts on NVDA, delta-hedged (e.g., NVDA 2y 10-delta puts)	26-Nov-25	\$8.30 / 49v	21-Jan-28	Tail hedge the AI trade with long-dated NVDA vol, which historically would have shown >35x payout vs carry cost.
Sell SX5E Jun26 var (22.8v) & buy 1.7x Jun27 var (23.7v)	26-Nov-25	22.8v/23.7v	19-Jun-26	Long fwd var is most attractive for SX5E vs global peers. Resize legs to cut carry cost by 4v (45% better vs regular sizing) while preserving risk/reward
Buy 110% Dec26 SPX calls qEUR for 4.33% (17 bps over vanilla)	26-Nov-25	4.33%	18-Dec-26	Foreign investors with unhedged FX risk in their equity investments can be subject to large swings on USD volatility, which quanto options can protect against.
Buy 90% Dec26 SPX puts qAUD for 3.66% (16bps less than vanilla)	26-Nov-25	3.66%	18-Dec-26	Foreign investors with unhedged FX risk in their equity investments can be subject to large swings on USD volatility, which quanto options can protect against.
Buy Dec26 ATMf call on return dispersion on bank names for 3.50% and strike of 17.28% (SX7E spot ref: 234.93).	26-Nov-25	3.50%	18-Dec-26	EU banks' broad thematic tilt supports ongoing return dispersion. Trade gains 50% of time (including recently) and offers a 2.3x reward/risk.
Buy an 18-Sep-26 105% worst-of call on KOSPI2 / TSM US / GLD US for 3.28% (indic. qUSD, 50% disc to cheapest call, on GLD)	17-Feb-26	3.28%	18-Sep-26	Gain cheap exposure to upside in KOSPI, TSM, GLD if bubble like price action continues
Buy Sep26 NKY>104% & USDJPY<98% dual digital for 16% (+32 correl offer, ref: 56,942, 153.6) 6.25x max payout	17-Feb-26	16%	Sep26	Nikkei upside trades can be cheapened if willing to lean optimistic on the yen. Indeed, the yen rallied 3.0% in the week after the 8-Feb lower house election and the Nikkei was up 5.0%
Long SPX 2028 annual dividend futures outright for \$80.80 indicatively.	2-Mar-26	\$80.80	Dec28	Flat SPX div term structure cheapens long dated futures that could converge to bottom up div estimates as uncertainty risks decay
Buy US 6m5y receivers ATM-25bps contingent on SPX < 100% for 34c indicatively (ref. 3.63%, 6650)	2-Apr-26	34c	2-Oct-26	Hedge slowdown expectations cheaply using equity-rates correlation at historic entry point
Buy 5y SOFR < ATM-25bp & SPX < 92.5% 6m dual digitals for 10% indicatively (ref. 3.63%, 6650)	2-Apr-26	10%	2-Oct-26	Hedge slowdown expectations cheaply using equity-rates correlation at historic entry point
Long Dec27 NDX vs SPX variance swap switch for 5.25v indicatively	20-Apr-26	5.25v	Dec27	Position for asymmetric AI & tech IPO exposure as potential AI bubble inflates
Buy QQQ Dec26 90% max lookback put (daily obs.), sell QQQ Dec26 80% vanilla put, for 3.57% indic. (+1x, -1x, ref. 713.29)	11-May-26	3.57%	Dec26	Mitigate strike & timing risk in strong momentum environment with expanding put spreads
Long NDX Dec27 corridor Var replication (100%-160%) at -20v	08-Jun-26	20v	Dec27	Strong pipeline of AI/tech IPOs that could qualify for NDX fast-entry in full view, our conviction in owning NDX vol remains strong
Buy NDX Dec27 90% upvar, sell SPX Dec27 80% upvar for 4.9v (t & t-1 convention on both legs).	08-Jun-26	4.9v	Dec27	Cheapen NDX vs SPX var switch for further AI bubble expansion



Table 1: Summary of open trades as of 05-Oct-26

Summary of open trades as of 05-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Expected Trade Term	Rationale
Sep-26 SX7E>106%, EURUSD < 1.14 dual-digital for 10.49% (offering 9.5:1 leverage)	22-Jun-26	10.49%	Sep26	EZ Banks upside: More post-war cyclical relief with potential rotation tailwinds
SX7E Sep26 106% call, contingent on EURUSD <1.14 at maturity for 1.01% (58% discount vs vanilla calls)	22-Jun-26	1.01%	Sep26	EZ Banks upside: More post-war cyclical relief with potential rotation tailwinds
SX7E Sep26 107% call, contingent on SX5E <= 104% at maturity for 1% (54% discount vs vanilla calls). Trade refs: 295, 1.1451, 6294 respectively	22-Jun-26	1%	Sep26	EZ Banks upside: More post-war cyclical relief with potential rotation tailwinds
NDX Dec26 110% call contingent on EURUSD < 100.75% for 1.55% (60% discount to vanilla)	22-Jun-26	1.55%	Dec26	Cheaper tech upside with equity-FX correlation amidst hawkish Fed shift
Buy Sep26 30D-15D (118%-134%) call spread on ENR fully funded by selling a Sep26 35D put on SXEP (refs: 157.06, 482.47)	29-Jun-26	0	Sep26	ENR's ascent reshapes SXEP: Fund AI-upside with SXEP put
Buy 0.84x Sep26 97% SX5E put, funded by a short 97.6% Sep26 SXXP put (~31% delta each, refs: 6265.98, 640.52 respectively)	13-Jul-26	0	Sep26	SX5E vs SXXP put switch is a historically cheap hedge against cyclical weakness
Buy NKY 3-month 95% put with an 80% Knock Out for 1.15% (indicative, -7% delta, 74% discount to vanilla put)	13-Jul-26	1.15%	13-Oct-26	Cheaper Nikkei correction hedges by 74% by selling large downside vol
Buy the 19-Aug-26 2330 TT 110% 120% 1x2 call ratio for 1.3% (7.7x max payout, +6 delta, 43.0% 39.0% vols) +1x 110% call / -2x 120% calls	13-Jul-26	1.3%	19-Aug-26	TSMC – Cheap stock replacement for 7.7x payout ahead of Thursday's earnings
Buy SPX Dec26 95%-80% put down-and-out (daily obs.) for 0.55% indic. (62% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 7615)	03-Aug-26	0.55%	Dec26	Hedge equity downside with grind lower structure in rotation-prone market
Dec27 197/205 1x2 call ratios on DEDZ8 (ref: 195).	25-Aug-26	0	Dec27	Lever limited SX5E div upside via call ratios, amid index change uncertainty
DEDZ8 Dec-28 197/205 1x2 call ratio financed by DEDZ7 Dec-27 192 call for (refs: 195.2, 188.4 respectively)	25-Aug-26	0	Dec28	Lever limited SX5E div upside via call ratios, amid index change uncertainty
Buy SPX Dec26 95% / 80% put down & out (daily obs.) for 0.55% indic. (50% discount vs vanilla put spread; ~25d/5d strikes; ref. 76.33,48)	01-Sep-26	0.55%	Dec26	Grind lower hedge against adverse midterm election outcome
Sell VIX Oct 16 put, buy VIX Nov 22-30 call spread for \$0.50 indic. (UXV6 ref. 18.85, UXX6 ref. 19.30)	01-Sep-26	\$0.39	Nov26	Monetize vol support from midterm election risk to cheaper long vol hedge
Buy IWM Nov 280 put for \$6.13 (~96%/33d strike; 20.3v; ref. 290.44)	01-Sep-26	\$6.13 / 2.1%	Nov26	Small cap vol looks underpriced for midterm elections vs 2024 presidential election move
Buy QQQ Oct26 730 calls for \$6.89 indicatively (~0.97% of spot; 16v, ~31d / 103% strike; ref. 709.18).	14-Sep-26	\$6.89	Oct26	Leverage retreating call vols to buy the dip in tech with limited risk
Buy QQQ Nov26 775-825 call spread for \$11.63 indicatively (4.3x max payout ratio; ~40d/10d strikes; ref. 756.20)	05-Oct-26	\$11.63	Nov26	Hedge US tech continuing to overcome macro with limited risk

Source: BofA Global Research. Prices reflective of most recently available data which may be delayed in some cases. "Trade Value" represents current valuation of trades initiated on the "Open Date"

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Summary of Closed Trades (05-Oct-26)

Table 2: Summary of closed trades as of 05-Oct-26

Summary of closed trades as of 05-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Close Level	Close Date	Rationale
Buy SPX 30-Sep 6350-6100 put spread for \$37.2 indicatively (6.7x max payout ratio; ~35d/15d strikes; ref. 6415.54).	2-Sep-25	\$37.20	0	30-Sep-25	Trade expired
Buy +1x QQQ Oct 605-625 call spread (~30D/10D strikes), sell -1x QQQ Oct 545 put (~10D strike) for \$1.87 indicatively (ref. 590.97)	15-Sep-25	\$1.87	0	17-Oct-25	Trade expired
Long SX5E 12-Sep ATM straddle for 2.4% indic. (Ref: 5291) and look to enter long V2X Oct, short Nov futures at -0.6v or better.	2-Sep-25	2.5%/-0.6v	0/-2.05v	Nov-25	Trade expired
Trade 1 (protection): Zero cost XIN9I 3-month 96% 90% 1x3 put ratios for 0.05% credit, rolled 1-2 months into the trade (indic. spot ref 14,962, delta -6.1%, vols: 18.5/17.4); +3x 90% puts -1x 96% put	26-Aug-25	0%	0	Nov 25	Trade expired
Trade 2 (participation): XIN9I call spreads for investors wanting to add upside. Buy XIN9I 3m 105% 115% call spread for 1.38% (indic. spot ref: 14,962, 20% delta, vols: 20.1/23.0, 7.2x max payout)	26-Aug-25	1.38%	0	Nov 25	Trade expired
XIN9I 3-month 95% 85% put spreads for 1.7% (indic. spot ref 14,825, delta -22%, vols: 20/21v, 5.9x max payout)	9-Sep-25	1.7%	0	Nov 25	Trade expired
Buy long VIX Nov 18 puts vs short VIX Apr 18 puts for \$0.10 indicatively	22-Sep-25	\$0.10	\$23.9	Nov-25	Trade expired
Buy NDX Dec25 ATM upvar for 17v indicatively (t & t-1 convention, Dec25 var ref. 25.1v)	26-Nov-24	17v	15.77v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy NDX Dec25 80% upvar for 20.15v indicatively (t & t-1 convention, Dec25 var ref. 25.1v)	26-Nov-24	20.15v	23.36v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy NDX Dec25 ATM upvar for 16.8v indicatively (t & t-1 convention)	27-Jan-25	16.8v	15.12v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy NDX Dec25 ATM upvar for 18.15v indicatively (t & t-1 convention)	24-Mar-25	18.15v	14.98v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy 31-Dec-25 SPX 6250/5750/5250 put ladder (+1x / -1x / -1x) for \$40.1 indicatively (12.4x max payout ratio; spot ref. 6373.45)	11-Aug-25	\$40.10	0	31-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SPX Dec 6300/5800 put spreads for ~\$75 indicatively or 1.16% of spot (6.6x max payout ratio; ref. 6449.23), outright or paired with long VIX Nov 18/15 put spreads for \$1.13 indicatively (2.6x max payout ratio, UXX5 ref. 20.70)	18-Aug-25	\$75 / \$1.13	0 / 1.99	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy SPX 31-Dec-25 95% / 85% down-and-out put for 0.31% indic (cont. obs., 32x max payout ratio, 68% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 6654).	13-Sep-25	31bps	0	31-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy SPX 31-Dec-25 95% / 85% down-and-out put for 0.28% indic (cont. obs., 35x max payout ratio, 65% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 6735.13).	20-Oct-25	28bps	0	31-Dec-25	Trade expired
Sell VIX Dec 16.5 puts (UXZ5 ref. 19.93) to buy SPX Dec 7000/7250 call spreads (spot ref. 6852.43). Sizing for zero cost is -0.7 SPX call spreads per ~100 VIX puts sold.	3-Nov-25	\$0.00	-\$0.49	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy 19-Dec-25 85%/65% Best of Put spreads on NKY/KOSPI2/ SPX for 0.90% (indic. quanto USD, 56% discount to avg vanilla)	26-Nov-24	0.90%	0	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy VIX Feb26 15.5/20/25 call spread collar for \$0.11 indicatively (UXG6 ref. 17.92)	12-Jan-26	\$0.11	0	18-Feb-26	Trade expired
Buy NKY Dec25/Dec26 31,000 straddle FVAs for 21.27% (indic. Q=2.5%, R=0.5%)	7-Apr-25	21.27%	9.39%	Dec25	Trade expired ITM
Dec25 +DAX vs -SXDP zero-premium call switch (20-delta strikes, refs: 24160 and 1036 respectively)	15-Jul-25	0%	-2%	Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SX7E Dec25 Appearing Put Spread (€205-€185-€160) for 2.65% (ref: 216.89)	4-Aug-25	2.65%	0	Dec25	Trade expired
Long Dec25 DAX vs SX5E 102.5% outperformance, conditioned on EURUSD > 1.2 at expiry for 0.84%	11-Aug-25	0.84%	0	Dec25	Trade expired
Buy DAX Dec25 call spread collar (+24800 call-25500 call-22400 put) for 0 cost	18-Aug 25	0	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Buy DAX Dec25 105% call contingent on EURUSD > 1.20 for 0.77%	18-Aug 25	0.77%	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Buy SX5E Dec25 put ladder +5350/-5125/-4875 for 10bps premium indicatively	18-Aug 25	10bps	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Replace FTSE longs with Dec25 103% (~28D) calls for 80bps (ref: 9299.84)	29-Sep-25	80bps	3.21%	Dec-25	Trade expired
Long Dec25 35d-15d (97.2%-92.3%) CAC put spreads for 0.98% indic (max payout ratio of 5.7x)	27-Oct-25	0.98%	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
DAX Dec25 102.5% calls, contingent on the CAC <102.5% at expiry for 39bps (~69% discount vs vanilla calls)	27-Oct-25	39bps	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Long Dec25 VolSwap dispersion on custom names vs the ESTX50	26-Nov-24	9.5v	12.0v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired +2.5%
Buy DAX Dec-25 85% upvar for 18.3v (fair variance ref of 23.3v)	11-Mar-25	18.3v	17v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SX5E Dec25 Volswap, short SX5E Dec25 Varswap for a credit of 2.9v indicatively (var ref: 23.75). For a more defensive alternative, short 0.95x Varswap vs the Volswap for 1.7v, indicatively.	6-May-25	2.9 credit	-4.3v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SX7E-SX5E Mar26 60-110% Corridor Var Spread for 7.7v (vanilla var refs. 9.9v, 31.5v & 21.6 respectively, T&T-1 convention)	4-Aug-25	7.7v	10.2v	20-Mar-26	Trade expired ITM
S&P calls quantoed into EUR (for only 3 bps more than vanilla Dec25 102.5% calls that cost 1.86%).	22-Sep-25	1.89%	0%	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Cheapening S&P calls by conditioning on EUR higher, also quantoed into EUR for 1.23%, a 35% cheapening vs Dec25 SPX 102.5% calls qEUR).	22-Sep-25	1.23%	0%	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Sell SX5E Dec25 ATM Downvar vs buy Var to collect 4.7v (T-convention, var ref: 19v)	29-Sep-25	4.7v	4.7v collected	19-Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy Dec25 FTSE div futures as a Dollar (vs Sterling) strength beneficiary	26-Nov-24	299.5	3.9 GBP	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy TWSE > KOSPI2 103% 11-Sep-25 outperformance call contingent on KOSPI2 up for 1.52%	3-Feb-25	1.52%	0	11-Sep-25	Trade expired
Buy TWSE 3m 110% calls & sell KOSPI2 3m 110% calls and collect 0.33% (spot ref 22,615 & 430.78, for TWSE and KOSPI2, respectively; 17.7/19.1% vols, 12.5/17.6 deltas)	15-Jul-25	0.33%	9.68%	Oct-25	Trade expired ITM
Sell NKY 1m 105% calls and buy 3m 105% calls for 0.98% (indic. Spot ref: 39,460, vols: 17.2/17.7)	15-Jul-25	0.98%	9.61%	Oct-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy Nikkei 10-Oct 2025 105%-115% call spread for 1.01% (indic. Spot ref: 40,998, 21% delta, vols: 17.3/18.1, 9.9x max payout).	29-Jul-25	1.01%	8.99%	10-Oct 25	Trade expired ITM
Long HSCEI 21-Nov-25 1x1.5 105% 110% call ratios for 0.39% (indic., options on futs, spot ref: 8,893, 12.8x may payout)	4-Aug-25	0.39%	0	21-Nov 25	Trade expired
Buy 12-Dec 25 NKY>SPX 103% outperf calls for 2.60% (indic.)	18-Aug-25	2.60%	1.27%	Dec 25	Trade expired ITM
Buy KOSPI2 3-month 105-115% call spreads for 1.62% (indic. spot ref: 478, 24d, vols: 19.2%/19.4%)	22-Sep-25	1.62%	8.38%	Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy NKY 3-month 105% 115% call spreads for 1.62% (indic. Spot ref: 45,043, 24.6 delta, vols: 19.2/18.8, 6.2x max payout)	29-Sep-25	1.62%	3.29%	Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy a TWSE 1m/2m 30k call calendar for TWD 183 (0.65% of spot, indic. spot ref: 27,994, 9d, +17.3 vega, vols: 18.3%/18.2%)	27-Oct-25	TWD 183	0	Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy NIFTYM 24-Feb-26 25.5k/26.5k call spread for USD 189 (indic. 0.75% of spot, spot ref: 25,048, vols: 11.9%/11.4%, delta 29.3%).	26-Jan-26	\$189	0	24-Feb-26	Trade expired
Buy TWSE 18-Mar 34.5k calls funded by selling 23-Feb 30.5k 28.9k put spreads for TWS65 (spot ref: 32,065)	26-Jan-26	TWS65	0	18-Mar-26	Trade expired
Sell NKY 13-Feb 57k calls to fund 13-Mar 57k/60k call spreads for JPY 277: 10.8x max payout (indic. 0.52% of spot, ref: 53,806, 31.9v 28.6v 28.3v, delta -2%)	2-Feb-26	JPY 277	0	13-Mar-26	Trade expired



Table 2: Summary of closed trades as of 05-Oct-26

Summary of closed trades as of 05-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Close Level	Close Date	Rationale
Buy QQQ Mar26 660-720 call spread for \$8.92 indicatively (6.7x max payout ratio; ~27d/7d strikes; ref. 599.44).	29-Sep-25	\$8.92	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Mar26 105% call contingent on XAU > 102% at expiry for 1.31% indicatively	29-Sep-25	1.31%	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Mar26 675-735 call spread for \$8.25 (7.3x max payout ratio; ~25d/7d strikes; ref. 611.56).	20-Oct-25	\$8.25	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy TLT Mar26 88 puts for \$1.31 (~30D strike, 4.1% OTM, ref. 91.78)	27-Oct-25	\$1.31	\$2.17	Mar26	Trade expired ITM
Buy TLT (20+Yr Treasury Bond ETF) Mar26 86 puts for \$1.03 (~25D strike, ref. 90.01)	26-Nov-25	\$1.03	\$0.17	Mar26	Trade expired ITM
Buy 30y SOFR > ATMF + 20bps / XAU > 106% Mar26 dual digitals for 7.95% (12.5x max payout ratio, ~18 correl offer, ref. 3.955%, 4078.70)	26-Nov-25	7.95%	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy GLD Mar26 490-550 call spread for \$9.9 indicatively (6x max payout; ~36d (5% OTM) / 11d (18% OTM) strikes; ref. 464.7)	26-Jan-26	\$9.9	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy 1x EWZ Mar26 40 call, sell 1x Jul26 48 call for 14c indicatively (28d/14d strikes, ref. 37.585)	17-Feb-26	\$0.14	-0.18	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy Mar26 straddle on liquid EZ banks vs short SX7E straddle for 2.36%	26-Nov-25	2.36%	1.2%	20-Mar-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy SPX MarQ 6525-5925 put spread for \$50 indicatively, ref 6795.99.	9-Mar-26	\$50.00	\$0	31-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy IWM MarQ 240-215 put spread for \$2.60 indicatively, ref 253.62.	9-Mar-26	\$2.60	\$0	31-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy GLD Apr26 450 calls (~106% / 35d strike), sell SLV Apr26 120 calls (~155% / 17d strike) notional-matched for zero cost indicatively (ref. 423.26, 77.34).	12-Jan-26	\$0	\$0	17-Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Apr26 6800/6300/5800 put ladder (+1x/-1x/-1x) for \$63.8 indicatively (7.8x max payout; ~40d/15d/5d strikes; ref. 6881.62).	2-Mar-26	\$63.8	\$0	17-Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Apr26 97%/85% PDO for 57bps indicatively (50% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 6881.62).	2-Mar-26	57bps	0%	17-Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy VIX Apr 20-18 put spread for \$0.50 mid indicatively (4x max payout ratio; UXJ6 ref. 24.30)	23-Mar-26	\$0.5 mid	\$2	15-Apr-26	Trade expired ITM
Long SX5E Apr26 6175 (~30d) call (1.2%, ref 5992.4), short V2X Apr26 18 put (ref 20.6) in a ~1.8 contract ratio for almost 0 cost (10bps credit of eq. notional)	17-Feb-26	10bps	0	Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy SXEP<95%, USO US > 110% May26 dual digital for qUSD 8.9% indicatively (11.2x max payout; ref. 517.66, 117.06)	16-Mar-26	8.9%	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy USO May26 80/70/60 put fly (+1x/-2x/1x) for \$1.9 mid indicatively (5.2x max payout ratio; ~30d/15d/5d strikes; ref. 87.19).	2-Mar-26	\$1.9 mid	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy VIX May26 18/25/40 call spread collar for \$1.03 indicatively on mids + bid-offer TBD at time of trade (14.5x max payout ratio; UXK6 ref. 22.95).	16-Mar-26	\$1.03 mid	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy VIX May 25-35 call spread for \$0.82 indicatively (12.2x max payout; UXK6 ref. 21.05).	13-Apr-26	\$0.82	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy VIX May 24-40 call spread for \$0.93 indicatively (~35d/10d strikes, 17.2x max payout, UXK6 ref. 20.81)	20-Apr-26	\$0.93	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ 29-May-26 635 call for \$9 indicatively (1.46% of spot; ~103% / 35d strike; 16.8v; ref. 617.507).	13-Apr-26	\$9	\$103.31	29-May-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy QQQ 29-May-26 665-700 call spread for \$7.5 indicatively (~35d/10d strikes, 4.7x payout, ref. 646.85)	20-Apr-26	\$7.5	\$35	29-May-26	Trade expired ITM
Sell initially delta-hedged KOSPI2 30-Dec-25 110% calls and collect 1.12% (indic. spot ref 535.28, 23.7% vol, 20d). Consider hedging the risk of a global tech rally into year-end by buying QQQ 31-Dec-25 110% calls against the KOSPI2 calls for 0.56% (17.8% vols, 14d)	20-Oct-25	1.12/0.56%	0	30-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy 1x 20-Mar-2026 106% call on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 2.92% (+29d, 27.4v). Sell 1x ASHR US 20-Mar-2026 35 call for \$0.71 (~2.15% of spot; the 35.00 strike is 106% of spot, ref 33.00) (*= several banks offer CSI tracking baskets; indic. in quanto USD)	3-Nov-25	2.92/2.15%	0	20-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy 1x 20-Mar-2026 106% call on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 2.32% (+27d, 26v). Sell 1.05x ASHR US 20-Mar-2026 34 calls for \$0.55 (~1.73% of spot; the 34.00 strike is ~107% of spot, ref 31.76)	26-Nov-25	2.32%/~1.73%	0.88%	20-Mar-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy KOSPI2 3-month put vs. short call spread for a 0.39% of spot, +1x 88% put / -1x 110% call / +1x 120% call	12-Jan-26	0.39%	0	Apr26	Trade expired
Buy HSCEI 17-Apr-26 9,500 10,500 call spreads financed by selling 8,500 puts for \$73 (indic. OOF, Apr fut ref 9,222, 47d)	9-Feb-26	\$73	0	Apr26	Trade expired
Buy 6-month 105% 125% call spreads on a CSI 1000 tracking basket for 2.53% (indic. 20d, 27.1v/28.7v, quanto USD)	26-Nov-25	2.53%	12.25%	15-May-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy Jun26 NKY > 104% & USDJPY < 96% dual digital for 9.7% (+48 correl offer, 10.3x max payout, ref. 48626, 157).	26-Nov-25	9.7%	0	12-Jun-26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Jun 6900 / 7600 risk reversal (-1x / +1x), delta-hedged (~95% / 105% strikes; 19.15v/11.96v; spot ref. 7268.50).	5-May-26	-19.2v/12v	-\$10.90	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy VIX Jun 25-40 call spread for \$1 indic (15x max payout; UXM6 ref. 20.95)	11-May-26	\$1	\$0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy TLT Jun 82-78 put spread for 51c indicatively (7.8x max payout ratio; 30d-8d strikes; ref. 83.65)	18-May-26	\$0.51	\$0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Jun26 95% put contingent on Brent > 130 for 84bps indicatively (68% discount to vanilla; ref. 6643.11, 101.84)	16-Mar-26	84bps	\$0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Jun26 660-750 call spread for \$18 (~35D/10D strikes, 5x max payout ratio, ref. 605.16)	26-Nov-25	\$18.00	\$80.66	18-Jun-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy Jun26 105% DAX call contingent on CAC < 105% at expiry	26-Nov-25	1.24%	0.2%	19-Jun-26	Trade expired ITM
Long CAC Mar26-Jun26 zero-cost put calendars, e.g. a Jun26 30D put fully funds ~1.6x Mar26 30D puts (spot ref: 8336.72)	12-Jan-26	0	5%	Jun26	Trade expired ITM
Long Jun26 105% DAX call, contingent on CAC < 105% at expiry for 1.12% (>50% discount vs vanilla calls)	12-Jan-26	1.12%	0	Jun26	Trade expired
Sell NKY 9-Jan-26 55,000 calls for a JPY589 credit (~1.12% of spot, or 6.7% annualised, 23d 23.1 vol)	10-Nov-25	JPY589	1.12%	09-Jan-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy Jun26 110% Worst-of Call on SXPP, SXEP, SX7E for 76bps offer (~50% discount vs the cheapest vanilla, spot refs: SXPP 737.05, SXEP 435.90, SX7E 275.44).	2-Feb-26	76bps	0	Jun26	Trade expired
SXEP Jun26 500 (~30D) puts initially delta-hedged	20-Apr-26	2.3% (put)	0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy Jun26 1x2 +19-17 V2X put ratios for 0.475 (fut ref: 21.95)	11-May-26	0.475	1.26	Jun26	Trade expired
Sell SOXX Jun26 485-540 1x2 call ratios (-1x / +2x), delta-hedged (~40d/20d strikes; ~41v/43v; ref. 455.410)	27-Apr-26	41v/43v	\$36.62	Jun26	Trade expired ITM
Buy 1.00x 18-Jun-2026 106% call on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 3.58% (+31d, 29v). Sell 1.05x ASHR US 18-Jun-2026 36 calls for \$0.74 (~2.20% of spot; the 36.00 strike is ~106% of spot, ref 33.82)	17-Feb-26	1.38%	-0.9%	18-Jun-26	Trade expired
Sell SOXX Jul 550/500 1x2 put ratio (-1x / +2x) for -\$0 indicatively (40d / 20d strikes; ref. 570.34).	26-May-26	\$0	-\$28.19	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Jul 750-800 call spread for \$7.62 (6.5x max payout ratio; 28d-5d strikes; ref. 716.07)	08-Jun-26	\$7.62	\$0	Jul26	Trade expired
SX7E Jul26 102% calls contingent on SX7P remaining at or below 102% for 0.77% qEUR (78% discount vs SX7E vanilla calls; 90% implied correl).	18-May-26	0.77%	0	Jul26	Trade expired
SX5E > 105%, EURGBP > 0.88 Jul26 dual digital for 7.69% (implied correlation offer ~22%, refs: 5800 & 0.87 respectively, 13x max payout)	18-May-26	7.69%	0	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy SXPP 2m (~Jul26) 1x2 40d-24d (105%-112%) call ratios for zero premium (spot ref: 841.03%) with a max payout of ~7%, to position for moderate further upside potential.	26-May-26	0	0	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy SPX 2-July 7435 daily straddle for 1.14% (spot ref: 7433) and this can be cheapened to 12bps by selling a SX5E 2-July (End-of-day) 4925 for 1.02% (spot ref: 6231)	29-Jun-26	12bps	0	02-Jul-26	Trade expired



Table 2: Summary of closed trades as of 05-Oct-26

Summary of closed trades as of 05-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Close Level	Close Date	Rationale
Buy NKY 6-month 95% put with vol knock out at 28% for 1.59% (indic., spot ref: 52,991, -11d, 69% discount to vanilla)	20-Jan-26	1.59%	0	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy XLV Aug26 165/170 call spread for \$1.2 indic. (4.1x max payout ratio; ~35d/10d strikes; ref. 162.19)	03-Aug-26	\$1.2	\$5	Aug26	Trade expired ITM
SPX > 109% / USDJPY > 100% Sep '26 dual digitals for 10% indic (10x max payout; target=90c; stop=10c, ref. 7360/156.73, -6 correll)	8-May-26	10%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
NDX Sep26 107% calls contingent on GBPUSD <1.32 for 1.06% (60% discount vs vanilla, refs: 29125 and 1.335 respectively)	18-May-26	1.06%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy NDX Sep26 105% calls contingent on ATMf < 10y SOFR < ATMf+25bps for 1.35% indicatively (57% discount to vanilla; ref. 30900, 4.09%)	15-Jun-26	1.35%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy VIX Sep 25-40 call spread for \$0.92 (16.3x max payout; ~35d/15d strikes; UXU6 ref. 19.65).	13-Jul-26	\$0.92	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy SMH Sep 650-750 call spread for \$14.6 indicatively (6.8x max payout ratio; ~28d/10d strikes; ref. 558.83).	20-Jul-26	\$14.6	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Sep26 7900 calls for \$73.30 indic (~35d strike; 12.05v; ref. 7753.11)	10-Aug-26	\$73.3	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy GDX Sep26 95 / 110 call spread for \$3.03 indic (~5x max payout ratio; ~40d / 15d strikes; ref. 90.49)	10-Aug-26	\$3.03	\$0.48	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy TLT 18-Sep-26 80.5-79 put spread and 81.5-83 call spread for \$0.49 indicatively (0.6% of spot; ref. 80.93).	14-Sep-26	\$0.49	0	Sep26	Trade expired

Source: BofA Global Research. Prices reflective of most recently available data which may be delayed in some cases. "Trade Value" represents current valuation of trades initiated on the "Open Date"

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH



Acronyms

BTD: Buy-the-dip

DUV: deep ultraviolet

FOMC = Federal Open Market Committee

NFP = Non-Farm Payrolls

SPY = SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust (ETF)

QQQ = Invesco QQQ Trust (ETF)

CPI = Consumer Price Index

XLF = Financial Select Sector SPDR Fund (ETF)

ATM = At-The-Money

XLV = SPDR Healthcare ETF

PDO = puts down-and-out

ENGI = Engie

WKL = Wolters Kluwer

VOW3 = Volkswagen

MLCC = Multilayer Ceramic Capacitor

MU = Micron

INTC = Intel

AFD = Alternative für Deutschland (Alternative for Germany)



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